The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called Benefiting Aṅgulimāla

Āryāṅgulimālīya-nāma-mahāyānasūtra · Toh 213 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སངས་མའོ་ཕྲེང་བ་ལ་ཕན་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པའོ།།

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called Benefiting Aṅgulimāla, known in Sanskrit as the Āryāṅgulimālīya Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as Phakpa Sormo Trengwa la Penpa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra set at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, where the Buddha teaches a vast assembly of bodhisattvas, monastics, and gods and spirits of every kind. It takes up the famous story of Aṅgulimāla, the killer who wore a garland of his victims' fingers, and retells it in a Great Vehicle light: Aṅgulimāla is revealed as a bodhisattva, and his teacher, his teacher's wife, and his mother as illusory emanations of the Buddha's skillful means, staged to bring countless beings into the Dharma. Along the way the sūtra praises the boundless, illusion-like body of the Tathāgata and the power of hearing the names of Aṅgulimāla and the youthful Mañjuśrī. It is Toh 213 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the General Sūtra section, and its colophon names an Indian preceptor, a Tibetan editor-translator, and a Chinese translator among those who rendered it into Tibetan.

In the language of India: ārya aṅgulimālīyaṃ nāma mahāyāna sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called "Benefiting Aṅgulimāla."

The first section.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the Blessed One, to a great many bodhisattvas, to the fourfold assembly, and to gods, nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, kinnaras, many great hosts of mahoragas, piśācas, hosts of bhūtas, daughters of the gods, lords of the asuras, the Sun, asuras, rākṣasas, the guardians of the world, māras, and others, was teaching the great sūtra of the most extensive Great Vehicle called The Bearer of Weapons, which surely liberates all sentient beings. He was fully and perfectly teaching the holy life, virtuous in the beginning, virtuous in the middle, and virtuous in the end, good in meaning, good in wording, unadulterated, complete, entirely pure, and entirely spotless.

At the time when the great sūtra The Bearer of Weapons had been brought to its conclusion, not far to the north of the great city of Śrāvastī there lived a brahmin youth called Lovely to All the World. He had been born in a town called Mountain Ridge, the son of an extremely poor brahmin woman called Bhadrā, and had been abandoned by his father. He was twelve years old, perfect in form, complexion, strength and courage, exceedingly lovely to behold, and gentle of speech. In the presence of the teacher Maṇibhadra, who had mastered the four Vedas and lived in a village called Halahase, the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World, very gentle, honoring his teacher, his senses subdued, keeping his vows unwaveringly, was studying the Veda of guarding the realm.

At that time the teacher Maṇibhadra was summoned by the king. As he was setting out for Śrāvastī, he left his own pupil, the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World, to watch over the house, and went to Śrāvastī.

Then the preceptor's wife, who was young, beautiful and endowed with every charm, saw the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World. Her mind became attached, she could no longer bear it, and her clothes and ornaments came loose and hung down. Overcome with desire, in great haste she seized the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World by his clothes, bent on desire, and so gave rise to demerit.

Then the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World, that most excellent of beings, by nature respectful toward his teacher, his senses tamed, keeping his vows unwaveringly, said to the preceptor's wife, "Lady, wife of my teacher, you are like a mother to me. Do not do this!" Since she would not think of letting him go, he abandoned one garment, and in shame went off, leaving that garment behind.

Then the preceptor's wife, having taken the measure of the mind of Lovely to All the World, her eyes filled with tears and overcome by lustful desire, began to brood. Then, in her pain, she thought, "This Lovely to All the World who stands in the way of my happiness, better that he die! Let him belong to no woman at all, and be turned to ashes!" She tore her whole body with her own nails until it was sore and painful. Having made her body unsightly, the woman contrived a deceit: she bound herself and hung herself up from the beam between the two houses.

Then the teacher Maṇibhadra, having been honored by the king, came back to his own house, and he saw her. When he saw her, he cut her rope, cried out

loudly, "Alas!" and said to his wife, "My good lady, what is this? Who has done this to you?"

The good lady said, "Your pupil Lovely to All the World forcibly lay with me and did this."

Then the teacher Maṇibhadra recognized the great power of Lovely to All the World. When he was first born, the moment he was born, the weapons of all the kṣatriyas had drawn themselves from their sheaths and fallen everywhere like arrows and axes, and at that time all the kṣatriyas were frightened and utterly terrified. Knowing that Lovely to All the World, that most excellent of beings, had such great power, the teacher was able to give him no more than a slight command, and he said to Lovely to All the World, "Wretch, you who have wronged your teacher's wife, you have committed a great offense, so you will not become a brahmin. Kill a thousand people, and then you will be purified."

When he had commanded his own pupil, the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World, in this way, the brahmin youth Lovely to All the World, who was by nature respectful toward his teacher, said to his own teacher, "O preceptor, this is not fitting for me."

Again the teacher said, "What, wretch? Do you not want to go to the higher realms, or to become a brahmin?"

Again the pupil said, "Very well, very well! Preceptor, I shall do so." He killed a thousand people, came back, and spoke respectfully to his own teacher. When the teacher saw him, he was amazed, thinking, "Look, this savage is still not dead!" and he thought, "In that case, now I shall make him die." Without saying that, he said, "Take the fingers of each one you have killed. Kill a thousand people, make the fingers into a garland, and come back. Only then will you become a brahmin." That is why he is called Aṅgulimāla, the Finger Garland.

Again Aṅgulimāla said, "Very well," and he killed two thousand people less one.

At that time Aṅgulimāla's mother, taking the choicest food and the four kinds of sweets, came, thinking, "Look what has become of my son! He must be suffering; I will feed him." When Aṅgulimāla saw his own mother coming, he thought, "I shall make my mother go to the higher realms," and he came toward her carrying a sword.

Then the Blessed One, knowing the place and the time, came from Śrāvastī in the dusk of evening, and at the foot of an aśoka tree, less than forty fathoms away, he who possesses all the wisdom of omniscience appeared before Aṅgulimāla like a king of geese.

Then Aṅgulimāla saw the Blessed One and thought, "In that case, I shall kill the ascetic Gautama," and carrying his sword he came on in great haste. Then the Blessed One, possessed of all wisdom, made it appear as though he himself were walking away. Aṅgulimāla, with his mother before him, looked on, and between the two of them he spoke these verses:

"Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Son of Śuddhodana, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Wearer of the dyed robe, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Chief among the wise, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Bearer of the alms bowl, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You with a lion's prowess, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You with a tiger's prowess, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You who walk well with the gait of a goose, please stop!

I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, divine elephant of graceful gait!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, supreme sun-crest of radiant vigor!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you of the full-moon face and lovely eyes!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You who are like a golden mountain, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with eyes like a thousand-petaled lotus!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You with the straight and lofty nose, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with the finest teeth, like the white water lily!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You whose tongue bears the supreme speech, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with the supreme curl of hair between the brows!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with the finest hair, lofty and lustrous!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with the finest long ears and long arms!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you whose fine arms are like an elephant's trunk!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you whose private parts are hidden in a sheath!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you who have the fair knees!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with the finest copper-colored nails!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you anointed with perfume by the highest beings!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you with the voice of the kalaviṅka bird!
I am Aṅgulimāla:

Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you who call out sweetly with the cuckoo's voice!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you who surpass the light of a billion suns!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
At this fitting time I bow to you and praise you!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you whose gait is so tamed and yet so swift!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You who have the strength of the ten powers, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
You who possess the supreme four truths, please stop!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, benefactor who teaches the eightfold path!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you who have the thirty-two supreme marks!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you who have the eighty excellent signs!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, you who gave up desire for the finest young women!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Stop, while I am not yet angry!
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!

Stop, ascetic, you there, please stop!
Vanquisher of asura lords and arrogant rākṣasas,
I have never seen such a wonder as this!
Who are you, with such exceedingly swift force?
Stop, ascetic, before I strike you with my sword!
Have you not even heard my name?

"I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!
Stop, ascetic, you there, please stop!
If merely hearing my name makes beings perish,
How could there be beings so mighty
That they see me face to face and stay alive?
Stop, ascetic, you there, please stop!
Though I am right here before you,
You go exceedingly fast, like a racehorse.
Are you a god or a nāga? Tell me quickly who you are!
Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
Now even I have lost my power:
Steadfast one, I cannot reach you.
I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!
Stop, ascetic, you there, stop!
If you, ascetic, keep the vows of discipline,
Do not pass by the toll station!

I am Aṅgulimāla:
Give me a finger as my toll!"

Then the Blessed One, like a king of geese, took seven steps, looked all around with the gaze of a lion, and spoke these verses to Aṅgulimāla:

"I abide at the limit of reality,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the uncreated limit of reality,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is peaceful and unborn,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the unconditioned,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:

I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no aging,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no sickness,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no death,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide free from all affliction,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there are no defilements,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no harm,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit of truth,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide firmly at the limit of the Dharma,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit of knowledge,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!

Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit of truth,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no sorrow,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand."

"I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is free from sorrow,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no dust,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is free from dust,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no decay,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no plague,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no torment,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no contagion,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!

Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is nothing at all,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is immeasurable,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is boundless,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is chief and supreme,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:

I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the utmost limit,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides in the sublime Dharma,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is unsurpassed,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit that is everlasting,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is indestructible,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

"I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the fearless Dharma,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the infinite Dharma,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the Dharma that cannot be shown,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the profound Dharma,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the Dharma that is hard to behold,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the subtle Dharma,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of the Dharma of the wise,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit that is hard to see,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is no foundation,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there is nothing base,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit where there are no afflictions,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit of purity,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of complete liberation,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!

Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit of peace,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I am one who abides at the limit of calm abiding,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of utter pacification,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.

I abide at the limit of utter cessation,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:

I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of utter pacification,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of the sublime,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit free of conceptual elaboration,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of non-abiding,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of taming pride,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of taming deceit,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of taming ignorance,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of complete relinquishment,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of definitive abandonment,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of the sphere of reality (dharmadhātu),
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of the sense sources,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of virtue,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of transcending the world,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of the unmoving,

And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of abode and dwelling,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of freedom from regret,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of thorough purification,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of reaching the very end,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!

Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of abandoning anger, delusion and desire,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of abandoning the afflictions,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of abandoning the aggregates,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of the exhaustion of anger, delusion and desire,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:

I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of cessation,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of support,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of protector,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of refuge,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of ally,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of island,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of knowing the right occasion,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of taming avarice and envy,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of taming thirst,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of self and no self,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of definitively abandoning the aggregates,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of all calm abiding,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of cutting off the road,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit that is the gateway of great emptiness,

And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of purity where all afflictions are abandoned,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of the exhaustion of craving,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of dispassion and cessation,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit of nirvāṇa, the supreme bliss,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!

Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
I shall give you a sharp weapon as your toll.
I abide at the limit that is permanent, stable, supreme, auspicious and utterly cool,
And that, Aṅgulimāla, you do not understand.

I am a perfectly complete buddha:
Pay your toll and drink the delicious elixir of the Dharma!
Stop, Aṅgulimāla, you there, stop!
Abide in perfect discipline, vows and virtues!
I am a perfectly complete buddha:
As your toll I shall give you a sharp weapon.
Quickly cast away this exceedingly sharp weapon,
And come swiftly to the refuge of the wisdom of awareness.
Come here! Your teacher, fallen under the sway of the lower realms,
Takes a heap of what is not Dharma to be the Dharma.
Then you will come to understand yourself.

All are terrified of punishment,
And to all of them life is dear.
Taking yourself alone as the example,
Do not kill, nor cause others to kill.

As others are, so am I;
As I am, so are others.
Taking yourself as the example,
Do not kill, nor cause others to kill.

Do not take on the guise of a rākṣasa like this!
Your limbs and body are thickly caked with blood,
And the sharp weapon of slaughter, smeared with blood,
That you carry on your shoulder is not becoming.
Cast the garland of fingers from your head at once!
Alas! If such are the deeds of a brahmin's son,
If even a brahmin's son who seeks the Dharma is like this,
What then must savage rākṣasas be like?
Even among cattle, a mother is honored.

Alas, merciless man, in the power of evil friends,
Brandishing an exceedingly sharp weapon,
You draw near to your own mother!
One like you, Aṅgulimāla,
Is a beast of prey among evildoing humans,
Most wicked among the rākṣasas,
A doer of savage deeds even among the asuras.
Aṅgulimāla, you are utterly entangled,
A thinker of evil, shunned by people.
A mother does the hardest thing in the world:
Through affliction she kept you ten months in her womb,
And then, after you were born,
She raised you, handling much excrement and urine, enduring suffering.
Look, Aṅgulimāla, at your mother:
Her eyes are brimming with tears of blood.
The woman, loving and fond of her son,
Has come carrying a jar of sweets on her shoulder.
The afflicted old woman's hair is torn loose by the wind;
Her poor, tattered clothes are tossed by the wind and fraying.
Her body is covered in dust, her feet are cracked;
The afflicted old woman is undergoing great suffering.
Her body is withered, long tormented by wind and cold;
She is sorely tormented by many sufferings.
That woman is utterly heartsick,
Filled with inconceivable suffering, and she cries out, "Alas!"

Then Aṅgulimāla's mother saw that, in the long and great debate, back and forth, retort and counter-retort, between the Tathāgata and her son Aṅgulimāla, her son had been defeated and had thrown down his weapon. Touched by the great suffering of love, she addressed the Blessed One in these verses:

Blessed One, the treasure of jewels that was lost
I have found, after enduring affliction.
I have gained what has become my eyes;
I have cleared away the dust from my eyes.
My son, alas, with human blood
Has stained his body and his food.

Roaming everywhere, carrying a sharp weapon,
He slays multitudes of beings.
Should I please my son,
Or bow to the Buddha? What am I to do?
"Your son is a wicked one like this!":
I cannot bear to hear the harsh words of so many people.

She lamented in this and many other ways. Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Aṅgulimāla:

"Aṅgulimāla, your mother is staying at the foot of a tree. To take up a sword and wish to kill this woman who does such exceedingly hard things, thinking, 'My mother will go to the higher realms,' is, Aṅgulimāla, to mistake a heap of what is not Dharma for the Dharma. It is like this: just as, in summer, in the first month of the hot season, deer wander everywhere, taking a mirage to be water, so you too, Aṅgulimāla, have been deluded by the instructions of an evil teacher; and a being who takes what is not Dharma to be the Dharma goes to the great and terrible hell called Avīci.

"Aṅgulimāla, go quickly to the refuge of the Tathāgata! Go! Enter! Aṅgulimāla, do not be afraid! The Tathāgata is the source of fearlessness. The Buddha looks upon all beings as though they were seized by Rāhu; he heals the sick and is the refuge of those without refuge. The Buddha, dwelling in solitude, is kin to those without kin. The Buddha is the inexhaustible treasure of the poor. The Buddha shows the good path to those who have lost their way. The Buddha has become the refuge of those tormented by fear. The Tathāgata has become a boat for those whose boats are wrecked.

"Quickly cast away your sharp weapon, and take up going forth and full ordination! Go, touch your head to the feet of your elder, and ask her forgiveness. Ask the afflicted old woman, 'Let me go forth,' and, having gained her consent, free beings from endless existence. I give you the excellent toll of going forth and full ordination. Aṅgulimāla, for a long time you have wandered on evil paths and grown weary, so drink the water that tastes of the Dharma! Aṅgulimāla, you are a taker of tolls, and the Tathāgata too is a taker of tolls. Aṅgulimāla, the Tathāgata is the toll-taking king of escorts for all beings: he ferries all beings across the ocean of existence and escorts them on the road, and always takes his toll."

Then Aṅgulimāla, right there, threw down his exceedingly sharp and terrible weapon, like a rākṣasa's. Just as a one-year-old child grabs a live coal, then throws the coal away, sucks his hand, and weeps and wails, so Aṅgulimāla too threw down that exceedingly sharp weapon, weeping and wailing. He took off from his body the garland he wore, made of the fingers of two thousand people less one, crying out, "Alas!" Just as a man who is asleep, the moment a snake seizes his foot, wakes at once, shakes it off as he pulls back his hand, grabs the terrible snake and flings it away, so Aṅgulimāla too quickly flung the garland of fingers from his head.

Just as someone who realizes he has been freed from a possessing spirit is overcome with shame, so then did Aṅgulimāla, coming to know himself. His whole body was covered in blood, the color of the flower called bandhujīvaka; his eyes were filled with tears like a great cloud, and he wept bitterly and beat himself. Just as a man seized by a snake goes mad and crawls along on his belly like a snake, so Aṅgulimāla too crawled on his belly over the ground for thirty-nine rods all around. Then he placed the Blessed One's feet upon his head and spoke these words:

Oh, Buddha, possessed of supreme loving-kindness,
Guide who tames beings, you came for my sake,
And today you have surely rescued me from the great ocean
Of delusion's dharmas, its great waves and its waters of unknowing.

Oh, Buddha, possessed of supreme compassion,
Guide who tames beings, you came for my sake,
And today you have surely rescued me from the wilderness
Thick with trees and roots, fruits and leaves.

Oh, Buddha, possessed of supreme joy,
Guide who tames beings, you came for my sake,
And today you have surely rescued me from the clutches of the tiger
Painted with the stripes of various views.

Oh, Buddha, possessed of supreme equanimity, who sees perfectly,
Guide who tames beings, you came for my sake,
And today you have rescued me from the depths of the great hells of beings,
Raurava, Mahāraurava and Avīci.

This is the refuge of those without refuge,
The kin of those without kin.
I have done dreadful deeds,

And I have become like this: I beg you, be my refuge!

Then the Blessed One spoke again to Aṅgulimāla: "Aṅgulimāla, get up and go quickly. Touch your head to your mother's feet and ask her forgiveness. When you have asked forgiveness, gain her consent by asking, 'Let me request going forth and full ordination.'"

Then Aṅgulimāla rose from the Blessed One's feet and went to where his mother was. When he arrived, he circumambulated his mother many times and, writhing like the crocodile called śiśumāra, the "child-killer," weeping and wailing, he spoke these verses to his mother:

Fallen under the sway of an evil teacher,
I have slain one thousand nine hundred people.
Alas, I have done terrible things!
I have gathered a great heap of evil.
Mother, you are my support,
And the Buddha is my supreme refuge.
Placing your feet upon my head,
I ask to go forth and receive full ordination.

Then the mother replied to her son in verse:

I have already let you go, my son:
Go forth, and practice for the world beyond.
I too ask the perfect Buddha
To let me likewise go forth.
Oh, the Blessed One is inconceivable!
The Tathāgata is beyond compare!
The Buddha, rescuer of my son,
Loves the whole world.
Protector, for your forms
And qualities there is no likeness among beings.
I can express only a little:
The Tathāgata is the god of gods.

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses to the old woman:

That you have allowed your son
To go forth in my presence:
Excellent, afflicted woman!

May you be happy without end.
Since for you the time
For going forth has long since passed,
Through the practices of a laywoman,
Old woman, give yourself relief.
Stay here just for a moment:
Until King Prasenajit
Comes into view here,
For that long remain at ease.

The second fascicle.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, surrounded and preceded by the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and by hosts of goddesses, lit up the whole region of Śrāvastī with a great light. He saw how the Tathāgata and Aṅgulimāla had contended, as men contend and as thoroughbred horses contend, and, overjoyed, he spoke these verses to the Blessed One and to Aṅgulimāla:

Oh, charioteer who tames men,
Buddha, rich in excellence and beautiful!
Oh, so it is that the Buddha
Has thoroughly tamed Aṅgulimāla.
His body ever smeared with human blood,
Lords of the asuras, gods and rākṣasas,
Yakṣas, full of strength and great prowess,
Nāgas, piśācas, mahoragas, kiṃnaras,
Garuḍas, strong and of great prowess,
And other fierce and powerful beings too,
On hearing the name of Aṅgulimāla, kept their eyes shut as if asleep.
Aṅgulimāla, doer of such fierce deeds:
How could a mere king of men ever slay him?
If at the very moment of his birth
The gods and asuras were all afraid,
What need is there to speak of a mere king of men?
At his name all armor and weapons seemed to burst apart.
One so violent, so strong, of such great prowess:
Oh, how well the Tathāgata has tamed him!
He possesses might and prowess beyond conception.
The Buddha is inconceivable; the Buddha's

Domain and the sphere of his wisdom are inconceivable.
Today Aṅgulimāla appears beautiful;
Exceedingly handsome, he has become like refined gold,
Beautiful like the color of the rising sun's rays.
Aṅgulimāla is lovely, beautiful, abiding in moral discipline;
A man without moral discipline is never beautiful.
Oh, today I feel I have gained much as a householder:
I shall present Aṅgulimāla with a Dharma robe.
Buddha, Blessed One, show me your kindness:
Grant Aṅgulimāla the appearance of a renunciant.
Upon this great king of all mendicants
I pray the Tathāgata to look with favor.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, spoke these words to Aṅgulimāla: "Holy being, make this supreme divine garment of mine your Dharma robe."

Then Aṅgulimāla spoke these words to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Who are you, you who are like a fly? Śakra, would I accept a gift from one without faith? Śakra, you are a lump of desire; you have not yet crossed many rivers. Being by nature naked, how can you give clothing to others? Since you are by nature naked, how can you give another a priceless garment to serve as a Dharma robe? For example, if a king's wrestler, a match for a thousand, himself falls flat with his whole body at the very start, like an old ox sunk in a bog, and falls without ever getting across, how could that old man overcome another wrestler who is a match for a thousand? Likewise, if I were to wear your priceless garment, Śakra, thousand-eyed one, how could I do battle with the koṭis of māras of the afflictions, the māras of my own nature, and the rest? I am to fight endless māras and bring many afflictions to an end. I am to practice the dharma of a renunciant, the twelve qualities of purification praised by the Tathāgata. I shall not dwell like that on your bedding.

"Śakra, thousand-eyed one, you are not the lord of the gods; you are no different from one who has gone blind. Śakra, you do not know the particulars of how evil fierce deeds are. How could you, who are like a fly, know Aṅgulimāla to be fierce? Alas, Śakra plainly does not understand fierce deeds. If you knew the way of the teaching: if one who wishes to go forth first of all puts on a priceless Dharma robe, what kind of renunciant will he become? Śakra, you do not know even the solitude of going forth. Alas, Śakra, you are outside the teaching!

"It is like this. Mahākāśyapa, the elder, the eldest son of the Tathāgata, gave up eighty thousand vases filled with jewels such as gems, pearls, beryl, gold and moonstones, as well as gold nuggets and countless other vases of jewels. He threw away priceless garments as though they were spittle and ashes, and went forth for good into the dharma of a renunciant. He makes his dwelling in the forest, restrained by the twelve qualities of purification, and practices austerity with his body. Why does he not wear priceless garments? Why did the elder Mahākāśyapa give up dwelling in houses, give up all kinds of ambrosial foods and foods with the taste of meat, and practice the conduct of austerity perfectly, without meat? He goes from house to house; though not mute, he regards himself as mute. Whether people say from in front, behind or beside him, 'There is nothing,' or revile him, he steadfastly goes away saying, 'May you be happy.' And if they say, 'There is something,' the elder does not become attached, but steadfastly goes away saying, 'May you be happy.' Since even a single one of those vases would allow future renunciants to enjoy food, sustenance and things to savor for as long as they live, why did he not set aside so great a heap of wealth as the property of the Saṅgha? Giving up all sense of ownership, he gave it away and made it an inexhaustible treasure for pretas, the poor, the destitute, beggars and others. Such, Śakra, is the dharma of a renunciant; to store up even as much as a sesame seed is not the dharma of a renunciant.

"Male slaves and female slaves, many kinds of wealth, landed property, and likewise buying and selling are not in keeping with the dharma of a renunciant; they are like the wealth of those who live in households. Those who accept the wealth just mentioned, and those who give such improper wealth, are alike fools. Those outrageous ones, flawed like the surface of a field that spoils the rice, I shall punish with chastisement.

"All those whom I killed and made into a garland of fingers were, every one of them, despoilers of the teaching; there was not a single layman, laywoman, male renunciant, or female renunciant among them."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to Aṅgulimāla: "The Dharma has the characteristic of not killing. Since the Tathāgata, moreover, looks upon all sentient beings as upon his only son Rāhula, how could he ever command that the limbs of the flawed and outrageous ones be cut off?"

Then Aṅgulimāla said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Śakra, how could you know the distinction between what is to be killed and what is not to be killed?

Just as a farmer does not understand the illusion of an illusionist, so too, Śakra, how could you, who stand outside the teaching like that farmer, understand the illusory domain of the bodhisattvas? Not killing and killing are also of two kinds: the killing of bodhisattvas and the killing of śrāvakas. How could you, who are like a gnat, understand these two kinds? The difference between the domain of the bodhisattvas and your own domain is like the flight of a gnat against the sky.

"Here is an example. When the renunciants have become mixed with false renunciants, suppose the renunciants set about restraining them, and many people ask, 'Why have you set about this restraint?' I ask you, Śakra: at such a time, is not the one who turns them back by restraining them in this way the best? If, when he has admonished them, someone should die from that restraint, to whom would the evil accrue? If his mind has been cleansed of the intention to kill, the evil accrues to no one. In the same way, if the flawed and outrageous ones die as a result of being punished with chastisement, the evil accrues to no one; rather, a great heap of merit is produced. Thus the distinction between killing and not killing is hard to know, and for bodhisattvas this does not become the act of killing.

"For example, a physician pricks a patient beside the tongue with a lancet and lets out blood. If the patient should die after that, would evil accrue to the physician? Because the physician brings benefit to many people, no evil accrues to the physician, unless he had the intention to kill. In the same way, if the flawed and outrageous ones die as a result of being punished with chastisement, the evil accrues to no one; rather, a great heap of merit increases, unless there was the intention to kill.

"For example, if a child dies the very moment it sees its teacher, would evil accrue to the teacher? In the same way, if a flawed and outrageous one, seeing the splendor of one who is heroic within, dies merely from seeing it, would evil accrue to the one who turns him back? No evil accrues to the one who turns him back; rather, merit greatly increases, unless there was the intention to kill.

"Therefore, Śakra, you do not know the distinction between evil actions and meritorious actions, and you do not know the distinction between a renunciant and one who is not a renunciant. But the outrageous ones who hate the true Dharma are to be punished with chastisement.

"The Elder Mahākāśyapa and the other eighty great śrāvakas, Śroṇa Koṭiviṃśa, Endless, and the others: all of them cast away many jars of wealth, kept few possessions, and were content, and so they abide in the true Dharma. Do they wear priceless garments? With the bodies of monks, heads shaven, every kind of pride destroyed, like those who have no protector, holding begging bowls in their hands, their robes and other things dyed and made of poor color, how could heedlessness be fitting for such monks? Always tormented by cold and heat, hunger and thirst, their hands and feet always touched by dust like those of wild animals, yet without even the stain of the slightest transgression of moral discipline, guarding moral discipline as a crow guards its egg: what have they to do with bustle and a delight in talk? Fearsome and unlovely in form like an elephant whose tusks have been cut: what have they to do with wearing priceless garments?

"Do not say such a thing a second time. Śakra, you are outside the teaching. Just as, among the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), an outcaste (caṇḍāla) has no part in the sacred commitments of the brahmins, so you too are an outcaste outside the teaching. You gnat, say nothing at all!"

Then Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, sent forth a great light and bowed with joined palms in the direction where the Blessed One was. He made a great divine offering to the Tathāgata and to Aṅgulimāla, and then spoke these words to the Blessed One and to Aṅgulimāla:

"Oh! I have witnessed a great battle,
Like two lions fighting fiercely.
Oh! The Buddha, charioteer of the untamed,
The Tathāgata, has tamed Aṅgulimāla into virtue.

As a snake, on seeing the physician, hisses loudly,
And, fearless, blowing out its breath, is swiftly tamed to calm,
So, on seeing the physician of the three worlds,
Aṅgulimāla, who did the most violent deeds, has become most gentle.

Homage to you, physician of the three realms!
Homage to you, king of the supreme wrestlers!
Tathāgata, who possess a body of skillful means,
Holder of inconceivable power, homage to you!

Having established Aṅgulimāla in the nature of reality,
Today, O Lord, you are utterly resplendent.
Beauty so great as this has no equal;

Therefore the Tathāgata is beyond compare.

Aṅgulimāla, abiding today in moral discipline, is utterly beautiful,
Gentle and pure and free of fear;
His form, by its very nature, is like gold,
Beautiful like the blazing hue of Jambū River gold.

I beseech the Tathāgata: out of love for me,
May the Tathāgata today accept my magical garment;
I ask that it be made the divine Dharma robe of Aṅgulimāla.
By its fruit, may I too attain supreme awakening.

May Aṅgulimāla, wearing my garment as his Dharma robe,
Perfect the holy life with a steady mind.
And you, Aṅgulimāla, in the presence of the Blessed One,
Keep the holy life to perfection."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world:

"Who are you, slanderous babbler? You speak to me with contempt, saying, 'Aṅgulimāla, wear my garment! Aṅgulimāla, keep moral discipline and austerities! Aṅgulimāla, keep moral discipline for a long time!' Wicked Brahmā, if you who are no Brahmā come here in the form of Brahmā, what is the meaning of the name 'Brahmā, Brahmā'? What is the work of Brahmā in the world? Shall I take a garment from someone like a gnat, put it on, and keep moral discipline and austerities for a long time? I am no one's slave, and I do not depend on anyone's faith. I owe no debt to anyone, for in the past I gave wealth to poor beings.

"For example, a swing hung by its rope in the first month of spring may go far, yet it quickly returns again to its own place. In the same way you too, Brahmā, you gnat, like a swing hung in the first month of spring, will taste the bliss of the Brahmā world and then fall, being subject to falling back. Not knowing the true meaning of the bodhisattva and the reasoning behind his qualities, those like you, who are like gnats, who judge what is evil and what is not evil, wander about in the realms of existence, unskilled and lacking, within the suffering of saṃsāra. Oh, Brahmā, if you know with certainty what is evil and what is not evil, then say, 'Aṅgulimāla has done violent deeds!' Wicked Brahmā, you who are like a gnat, you do not know; so learn the conduct of the bodhisattvas!"

Then Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world, again said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Aṅgulimāla, you have killed two thousand people less one, and the terrible thing you did is still plainly visible. Your violent deeds could not be done even by a crow or a hawk. If deeds such as these are not violent deeds, what kind are violent deeds? If one such as this is not a māra, what kind of terrible rākṣasa could there be? Aṅgulimāla, be heedful, and strive in such a way that the deeds you have done may be purified. Oh, the Buddha is compassionate; he surely delivers those who do violent deeds, such as Aṅgulimāla."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world: "Brahmā, where are you going, hopping and wandering about like a tiny insect? Beings who do not know what is evil and what is not evil go to the lower realms.

"Some fool went into the forest, and at night in the darkness he saw a swarm of fireflies on the roots of a tree. The wretch was terrified, came to the village and the market, and said, 'There is a forest fire!' Many people went there, and when they saw the fireflies in the pitch-dark night they said, 'This is not fire,' and one by one they went back again. In the same way you too, wicked Brahmā, by declaring, 'Aṅgulimāla is a fool,' have badly deceived yourself and many people. Later even you, who are like a gnat, will understand that heap of illusion, and many beings will understand it too.

"Some fool of confused mind went into the forest, and when he saw a grove of aśoka trees in full bloom, he thought, 'It is fire!' Terrified, he went to the village and the market, and many people went there in the same way, and gradually they came to know the difference between fire and aśoka trees. In the same way you, who are like a gnat, will gradually come to know what is evil and what is not evil. And afterward many people too will understand this, which is like a heap of illusion. So, wicked Brahmā, do not say such a thing a second time. Instead of practicing lies like this, those of feeble mind like you, who are like flies, should sit and say nothing at all!"

Then the Four World Guardians sent forth a great light, made a great offering to the Tathāgata and to Aṅgulimāla, and said this to the Blessed One and to Aṅgulimāla:

"Oh! A supreme contest of tigers among men,
Challenge and reply on the ultimate, most beautiful!
Oh! The Teacher, charioteer of the untamed:
Therefore you are the Buddha, holder of boundless power.
To your supreme feet, soft and supple as lotuses,

Untouched by dust, we bow down.
To the Tathāgata, our refuge time and again,
We pray: grant my begging bowl to Aṅgulimāla.
Today Aṅgulimāla is beautiful,
Beautiful like the moon in the sky.
Aṅgulimāla is beautiful, perfect in the qualities
Of moral discipline, in austerity and splendor."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said to the Four World Guardians: "Who are you, petty world guardians, who are like snakes? Thinking, 'We are world guardians, world guardians,' and swollen with pride, you try to lure me, saying, 'I shall give my divine begging bowl,' you who are as stingy as hungry ghosts. Just look for a moment, some other time, at how fearsome I am! When an earthenware vessel is of no use to anyone, do you, thinking yourselves protectors of the world, give me your divine cup? Those who reduce to ashes the vicious and outrageous ones in the world are known as world guardians. One should guard the Dharma rightly; one should not guard the world.

"Again, for example, someone hears the voice of a cuckoo, or sees its splendid color, and then a moment later, seeing a crow cawing, mistakes it and says, 'A cuckoo, a cuckoo!' In the same way you too, thinking it to be the Dharma, guard what is not the Dharma. Like one who sees a crow cawing in the forest and thinks it is a cuckoo, so are you. You four world guardians, guard the Dharma, and do not guard the world! World guardians, ignorant folk who are like gnats, you four, restrain yourselves and say nothing at all!"

Then Māra the Evil One came before Aṅgulimāla, made a great offering to the Tathāgata, and said this to Aṅgulimāla:

"Aṅgulimāla, you went forth so quickly!
That you entered my markets and towns and deceived them,
Aṅgulimāla, does not please me;
You have crossed out of the depths of the hells of beings."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to Māra the Evil One: "Evil One, thieving cur, you who are like a gnat, go away! Why do you speak so very boldly? Evil Māra, come out quickly today and be gone! Until you are bound with the five bonds like a dog and kicked with the left foot, until then, Māra, you may frolic as you please."

"I have emptied the villages, the markets, and every gateway of the valleys. Just as a garuḍa, dwelling on the summit of Mount Meru, seizes a young nāga when it sees one in the ocean many leagues away, so too I sport like a garuḍa among all the beings of the hells and satisfy them with the elixir of liberation. Ever cutting off your head, Māra the Evil One, the bodhisattvas, elephants among men, sport and play. Māra, you who are like a thieving cur, say nothing! Listen to the nectar words of the Dharma; stay for a moment, and when you have heard the Dharma, go back to your own city, and the markets and the cities will come to understand."

Then the divine son Maheśvara (Śiva) made a great divine offering to the Tathāgata and to Aṅgulimāla, and spoke these verses:

"Touching my head to the supreme feet of the Tathāgata,
I offer praise, a eulogy like the finest lotus.
Sugata, your eyes are like thousand-petaled lotuses, possessing a thousand petals;
Your supreme feet are soft, like a lotus of a thousand petals.
Your feet are like pale red lotuses, and no dust clings to them.
Your supreme feet are like utpala petals; your palms are exceedingly soft.
The fragrance of your face wafts like the finest utpala petals,
Cool, like utpala petals in the world.
The Sugata is lovely to behold in every way, like the finest utpala petals.
Your hair is soft and glossy, like the blue utpala.
Your hair is like the blue utpala, cool and of the finest fragrance;
Like the glossy hue of the blue utpala, it delights the mind.
Your hair is curling and fine, and you bear garlands of locks.
Your supreme teeth are like the kumuda lily and the moon.
Like the kumuda, the moon, and the heart of the lotus,
They are never stained by the taint of water or of fish.
Your teeth are stainless, like the kumuda and the moon.
Unsullied by faults, your supreme teeth are the color of the kumuda.
Your teeth dispel afflictions; you possess the teeth of supreme means.
Your intellect is stainless and clear, like the puṇḍarīka.
Like the puṇḍarīka, your supreme mind is pure;
Your mind, like the puṇḍarīka, is unsullied.
Buddha, you are a puṇḍarīka, rid of the faults of desire, anger, and delusion;
Buddha, you possess an intellect like a white lotus.
Just as fragrant utpalas are beautiful beside a lotus,

Today the Buddha is beautiful, and like a pair of utpalas, Aṅgulimāla is beautiful.
Aṅgulimāla is beautiful today, for thus even Māra the Evil One
Has first been tamed and defeated by one clad in white,
And again and again he sports with the Tathāgata.
He too will soon become a protector in the world.
Alas! Brandishing a sword, intent on slaying the Sugata,
Aṅgulimāla came here, minded to kill even his mother.
Today, at peace, he seems an ordinary being blessed with good fortune.
The words of one who speaks the truth never turn out otherwise.
So that the evil you have done may be purified in this very body,
Undertake it thus, Aṅgulimāla, with diligence.
Alas, hero, though you committed fierce deeds,
Today you have become a lord of the Dharma, and I rejoice."

Then Aṅgulimāla again spoke to the divine son Maheśvara: "Who are you, fierce one of unsightly bearing? You think of yourself as a lord, but you are a lord in name only, not a lord in truth. Tell me quickly: how do you know who is an ordinary being and who is an arhat? Lord, since your fangs are as sharp as a piśāca's, have you still not attained a perfect form? Consider: if a man afflicted with severe leprosy were to teach the complete cure of leprosy, worldly people would think, 'How can one who cannot cure his own disease heal the disease of others?' In just the same way, fierce one, you who are like a gnat, though you suppose you understand yourself, you still do not know even your own element. Fierce one, like a man afflicted with severe leprosy, how could you know another's mind, saying, 'Aṅgulimāla is an ordinary being,' or, 'He is an arhat'? You who are like a gnat, say nothing! You are not fit to be empowered as lord of the earth, nor to be regent of the lord of the earth. You who are like a blind man, keep still for a moment!"

Then the goddess of the tree against which the Tathāgata was sitting spoke these verses to Aṅgulimāla:

"Hero Aṅgulimāla, quickly
Put on the saffron banner,
And first take alms together with the Sugata.
Hero, you will attain the sacred fruit."

Then Aṅgulimāla spoke to the goddess in verse:

"The Tathāgata does not eat food,
And so it is with the śrāvakas as well.
To whom, then, will you give your gift?
Speak quickly, wide-eyed Bhadrā,
And cut through my doubt."

Then the wide-eyed goddess again spoke to Aṅgulimāla in verse:

"The Buddha always partakes of food,
And so it is with the śrāvakas as well.
For a steadfast one who wishes to go forth,
It is not fitting to speak falsely.
Abandon false words entirely;
A deceitful intention is evil.
For a person who has transgressed a single dharma
And speaks false words,
Who has cast aside the world beyond,
There is nothing he will not do."

Then Aṅgulimāla said this to that goddess: "Woman, what are you rambling on about? You too were born into a lowly station, so, you who are like a gnat, understand well the nature of womanhood that the Buddha has disparaged. Who in the world speaks falsely? Who in the world holds to the truth? Who in the world is attached to material things? Who in the world falls ill and dies? You who are like a gnat do not know. Those beings who do not know the great nature of the Tathāgata's qualities are the ones who speak falsely. Those beings who, being attached to material things, honor even the Tathāgata with material things are the ones who speak falsely; since they do not even have going forth, how could they have full ordination? Those beings who do not know the Tathāgata's intentional speech are the ones who speak falsely; since they do not even have going forth, how could they have full ordination? I do not transgress even a single dharma. But you, goddess, have transgressed all dharmas, so quickly ask forgiveness of the Tathāgata, the god of gods, the perfectly complete Buddha."

Then the goddess again said this to Aṅgulimāla:

"Why do you speak in veiled language, saying that the state of a woman is a lowly station? Aṅgulimāla, how do you know whether one is a woman or a man? Aṅgulimāla, tell me quickly! Your piśāca nature has not yet been pacified."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to that goddess: "Just as a dog that gets onto a king's bed and scratches about is a creature that defiles it, so too you, goddess, playing with the Dharma of skillful means, have transformed yourself into the state of a woman, and you set your mind on objects of desire and scratch about. Therefore, goddess, abandon the state of a woman, and meditate on what are called 'man' and 'woman' as utterly empty. If you become accustomed to utter emptiness, you will quickly attain the state of a man."

Then at that time Śāriputra and Maudgalyāyana, by the power of their miraculous abilities, came through the sky like kings of geese. They went to where the Blessed One was, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, sat down to one side, and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, son of noble family, excellent! Know that you have made merit that is fitting and in accord with his intent. Go together with the Tathāgata, take your place among those who practice the pure life together, and let us go to the park of Anāthapiṇḍada in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta. When the Blessed One has ordained you, set out, for the great multitude of people in the world to see, like the stainless moon in the sky and like a king of geese, and let us go."

Then Aṅgulimāla again spoke in verse to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana:

"Who in the world possesses miraculous power?
From what root does miraculous power arise?
Tell me quickly how one comes to possess miraculous power,
And quickly dispel my doubt."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana again spoke to Aṅgulimāla in verse:

"If patrons in the world
Always give generously, even shoes,
If to monks perfect in moral discipline
They offer footwear of every kind,
By these two ways,
One who wants miraculous power attains miraculous power.
Aṅgulimāla, understand it thus:
If you want miraculous power, act thus."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Alas, Venerable Maudgalyāyana, you engage in the conduct of a gnat and do not understand miraculous power in its entirety. A gnat too goes through the sky. You whose miraculous power is the power of a gnat, say nothing! One thinks,

'Having been freed myself, I shall free others,' and by that beneficial mind one quickly accomplishes the possession of miraculous power. When one who teaches the sacred Dharma for the benefit of others is in distress, if one gives up one's own life before him, by that one accomplishes the possession of miraculous power. What miraculous power could there be in the Victor's Grove greater than delivering many koṭis of beings? So I shall not go. Thus, since the Great Vehicle is immeasurable, the Tathāgata too is immeasurable."

Then Aṅgulimāla spoke these verses to the venerable Śāriputra:

"Who in the world has great wisdom?
How does intelligence come to arise?
You of great gnosis, quickly, quickly,
Tell me, and cut through my doubt."

Then the venerable Śāriputra again spoke in verse to Aṅgulimāla:

"By carefully guarding the five precepts,
One will attain supreme intelligence and great wisdom.
Having cast off this body, keeping one's own intelligence,
One is born wherever one wishes,
And in each such place one comes to have great wisdom,
With renown proclaimed in every direction, Aṅgulimāla.
Great hero, intelligent one, understand it thus."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to the venerable Śāriputra: "Great wisdom arises from this deathless word that teaches, 'The Tathāgata is permanent.' The one who teaches thus, endowed with wisdom, is the Buddha. Alas, the Venerable Śāriputra of great wisdom engages in the conduct of a gnat; you who go about like a gnat do not know what it is to possess wisdom. You whose wisdom is like a gnat's, say nothing! The Venerable One has the wisdom of a gnat."

Then at that time Ānanda came there, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and in accord with his intent. Aṅgulimāla, quickly study the scriptures of the nine branches."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to the elder Ānanda: "Since the Tathāgata has declared you supreme among the learned, Venerable Ānanda, I ask you; tell me. Who in the world is learned? How does one come to be learned? Venerable Ānanda, quickly answer what I have asked."

Then the venerable Ānanda again said this to Aṅgulimāla: "By reading the sūtras of the nine branches and teaching them thoroughly to others too, without stinginess, one becomes learned and comes to hear the perfect, inconceivable dhāraṇīs."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said this to the elder Ānanda: "To teach in the world the teaching that the Tathāgata is everlasting and eternal: that teaching is learning in the world. Understand learning to be like that. Alas, the Venerable Ānanda engages in the conduct of a gnat and does not know the door through which learning arises. Even a gnat has learning; you whose learning is like a gnat's, say nothing!"

Then the elder Rāhula went to where the Blessed One was and, having arrived, said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, son of noble family, excellent! I rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and in accord with his intent.

Aṅgulimāla, quickly take up the trainings with respect."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said to Rāhula: "Venerable Rāhula, since the Tathāgata has declared you supreme among those who delight in and respect the trainings, who in the world is respectful toward the trainings? Beloved son of the Tathāgata, tell me quickly and cut through my doubt."

Then the elder Rāhula spoke to Aṅgulimāla in verse:

"Hold the words of the Buddha with deep respect;
Then one respects the trainings and is endowed with moral discipline,
Has mastered inner courage and upholds supreme inner courage.
Aṅgulimāla, understand it thus."

Aṅgulimāla again said this to Rāhula: "To teach with respect in the world that the Tathāgata is supremely permanent is called supreme respect. Venerable Rāhula, know that one who teaches this is supreme in the world in respect for the trainings. O Venerable Rāhula, you engage in the conduct of a gnat; you who are like a gnat do not know respect for the trainings. Even a gnat has respect; you who are like a gnat, say nothing!"

Then the elder Aniruddha went to where the Blessed One was and, having arrived, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and in accord with his intent. Aṅgulimāla, now, without delay, become one who has the divine eye."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to the venerable Aniruddha: "Venerable Aniruddha, since the Tathāgata has declared you supreme among those who have the divine eye, who in the world has the divine eye? How does the divine eye arise? Tell me quickly and cut through my doubt."

Then the venerable Aniruddha in turn spoke these verses to Aṅgulimāla:

"Through lamps one always gains the eye;
Or else, know that it comes as well
From diligently teaching the Dharma to others.
Among those with form, one has the supreme form.
Aṅgulimāla, understand it thus."

Then Aṅgulimāla said this to the venerable Aniruddha: "If one diligently and without concealment teaches the tathāgatagarbha, a teaching for the benefit of all beings, one will thereby gain the divine eye; that one is the possessor of the divine eye in the world. Alas, Venerable Aniruddha, you engage in the conduct of a gnat and do not know how to develop the divine eye. Even a gnat sees its own domain; you who are like a gnat, say nothing!"

Then the elder Servant of Śramaṇas bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and in accord with his intent. Aṅgulimāla, now you should cultivate patience abundantly."

Then Aṅgulimāla said this to the elder Servant of Śramaṇas:

"Who in the world is perfect in patience?
How does one who wishes for patience become patient?
In what way does one come to be patient?
Tell me quickly and cut through my doubt."

Then the elder Servant of Śramaṇas in turn said to Aṅgulimāla:

"A monk who wishes for patience
Should be like the axe and the sandalwood.
Then he will attain patience;
That is forbearance like the dust of the world.
Aṅgulimāla, understand it thus."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to the elder Servant of Śramaṇas: "In the world there are people of wrong views, unskilled in teaching the tathāgatagarbha, who are hostile and who take their stand on the claim, 'The teaching is selflessness'; they do not make themselves familiar with these

words. Thinking, 'This is without equal,' to teach the tathāgatagarbha even at the cost of one's own life: that is the highest patience, teaching for the benefit of the world. In the world, patience is tamed, peaceful, and fearless. Alas, elder Servant of Śramaṇas, you engage in the conduct of a gnat and do not know how to develop patience. Even a gnat endures hunger and thirst; you who are like a gnat, say nothing!"

The third fascicle.

Then Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I too rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and in accord with his intent. Aṅgulimāla, give a Dharma discourse, a teaching for the benefit of all beings."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra: "Pūrṇa, since the Buddha has declared you supreme among the teachers of the Dharma, Venerable, who in the world is a teacher of the Dharma? In what way is a monk one who knows the meaning? Venerable, supreme among teachers of the Dharma, tell me!"

Then Aṅgulimāla said this to Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra:

"That which all the buddhas and śrāvakas
Have never found anywhere at all,
Having fully awakened to that Dharma,
One should teach it to living beings.

What is the meaning of these words?"

Pūrṇa said: "The past buddhas, the blessed ones, searched with the utmost diligence in all phenomena for a realm of sentient beings, a self, a life, a person, one born of Manu, and a son of Manu, but did not find them; and thinking, 'Selflessness is the word of the Buddha,' they passed away. The present buddhas, the blessed ones, too, though they search with the utmost diligence in all phenomena for a realm of sentient beings, a life, a person, one born of Manu, and a son of Manu, do not find them. The buddhas, the blessed ones, who have not yet come, too, though they search diligently in all phenomena for a realm of sentient beings, a life, a person, one born of Manu, and sons of Manu, will not find them. In the same way, all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas too, though they search diligently throughout the three times in all phenomena for a life, a person, one of Manu's line, a son of Manu, an element of sentient beings, and a self, did not find them, do not find them,

and will not find them. Thus they teach that there is no realm of a life, a person, one of Manu's line, a son of Manu, a sentient being, or a self. Thus they teach selflessness; thus they teach emptiness; such is the Dharma discourse they give."

Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra: "Alas, Venerable Pūrṇa, you engage in the conduct of a gnat and do not know how to give a Dharma discourse. Even a gnat knows how to make a buzzing sound; you fool, like a gnat, say nothing! Pūrṇa, because you do not know the Tathāgata's intentional speech, you take selflessness to be the Dharma, and like a moth you fall into the lamp of the dharma of delusion.

"As for 'that which the buddhas have not found': the past buddhas, the blessed ones, did not find in any sentient being an absence of the tathāgatagarbha, and they passed away. The present buddhas, the blessed ones, too, do not find in any sentient being an absence of the element of the self. The buddhas, the blessed ones, who have not yet come will not find in any sentient being an absence of the element of sentient beings. Pratyekabuddhas and śrāvakas too, throughout the three times, did not find, do not find, and will not find in any sentient being an absence of the tathāgatagarbha. This is the meaning of that verse.

"Again, as for 'that which all the buddhas have not found': the past buddhas, the blessed ones, though they searched diligently in all phenomena, did not find the self as worldly people conceive it, said to be the size of a thumb, or of a chickpea, a grain of rice, a mustard seed, or a sesame seed, red, blue, yellow, or white, short, long, or very long, and so on, blazing as it dwells in the heart; or said to dwell at the navel, in the head, the eyes, or the ears, like the red heart of a butter lamp blazing by the condition of its oil, and so forth. These many kinds of conceptions with which worldly people meditate on a self, that on which they rely as permanent and everlasting, saying, 'The self is like this,' all the buddhas and all the śrāvakas did not find; and having fully awakened, they explained this to living beings. This is the meaning of that verse. Since Pūrṇa has analyzed it in an inverted way, his is not its meaning.

"As for 'that which the buddhas have not found': the past buddhas, the blessed ones, too, did not find a tathāgatagarbha that is made, and they passed away; an unmade buddha-element, adorned with the infinite major marks and excellent minor marks, exists in all sentient beings. The present buddhas, the blessed ones, too, though they search diligently, have not found a

tathāgatagarbha that is made; in all sentient beings there exists an unmade buddha-element, adorned in all sentient beings with infinite major and minor marks.

"Throughout the three times, śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, who are like flies, hear it proclaimed that the tathāgatagarbha exists, and to them, as they ask, 'Why can it not be seen with the eye?', the reason is taught. It is like this: Rāhula, out of devotion to the glorious trainings and moral discipline, looks very diligently at water that contains living creatures, thinking, 'Are these living creatures or not? Or is it something like dust? It is nothing at all'; then, examining it step by step, he sees that they are tiny creatures. In just the same way, bodhisattvas who are tigers among beings, having attained the ten grounds, see for themselves that the element of the self exists in their own bodies, and they see that such as this is a boundless expanse. Thus to enter into the tathāgatagarbha is to do what is extremely difficult. Those who, in a world that is ablaze and blazing fiercely, teach it even at the cost of their own lives, are doing what is exceedingly difficult and teaching for the benefit of others. To those tiger bodhisattvas I teach the tathāgatagarbha; I do not teach it to others. Those beings are themselves tathāgatas.

"For example, it is like Aniruddha among those who possess the miraculous eye. Suppose a child with fleshly eyes goes along with Aniruddha and looks for the trail of a bird that has flown across the sky. Does the child with fleshly eyes see the bird's trail in the sky? The elder Aniruddha sees it clearly, and the person with fleshly eyes goes along, placing full trust in the elder. In the same way, all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, who are like the child with fleshly eyes, trust in the way of all the sūtras and so know that the tathāgatagarbha exists; but how could they truly see even the expanse that is the Tathāgata's domain? If śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas place their trust in someone else, how could they trust a mere blind man?

"I have heard from the perfectly complete buddhas of the past, who never speak otherwise, that in the earliest times this earth came to have four kinds of sweetness. Those beings who tasted the four sweet flavors still eat earth when they are children; the delicious taste to which they have long been accustomed, those beings still cannot give up. In the same way, those beings who meditated on the tathāgatagarbha and cultivated it much in the presence of many perfectly complete buddhas of the past still trust in the tathāgatagarbha. Those beings have long meditated on it and repay the kindness of the Tathāgata; they are no others. In the future too, the beings

who teach the tathāgatagarbha, and who come to trust it on hearing it, are no others; like children of the Tathāgata who eat earth, they repay the kindness of the Tathāgata.

"Those beings who formerly were cattle, who mounted their own mothers and were wild with lust for their mothers, still grind their teeth, making a grating sound as they sleep, and they do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha, the Dharma of suchness. In the future too, the beings who grind their teeth with a grating sound and do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are those who were cattle and who do not know the nature of reality. Those beings who formerly were pigeons have a strong desire for forms and have fallen under the sway of lust; for the most part they do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha, and they commit violent deeds. In the future too, the beings who have fallen under the sway of lust for the most part do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha; those beings are no others than those who were pigeons, long habituated to the afflictions.

"Those beings who formerly were shameless crows, utterly ungrateful and eaters of filth, are still poor and shameless, and they do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha. In the future too, the beings who, on hearing of the tathāgatagarbha in the presence of one who teaches for the benefit of others, laugh and walk away, the beings who do not trust in the element of the self, are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are the shameless, filth-eating crows.

"Those beings who formerly were ugly monkeys, whose minds stir like the many-colored waves of the ocean, still become agitated in mind when they hear of the tathāgatagarbha, and they do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha. In the future too, the beings who become agitated in mind on hearing of the tathāgatagarbha and who do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are the base ones who laugh like monkeys.

"Those beings who formerly were owls, who see very poorly by day and see at night, the beings who do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha, still, when they see a worthy teacher in the world, do not even want to look at him. In the future too, the beings who hear of the tathāgatagarbha in the presence of one who teaches for the benefit of others and do not trust what the Buddha has declared, Venerable Pūrṇa, are those who were owls; they do not trust it, as though it were a fortune-teller's words.

"Venerable Pūrṇa, those beings who formerly were born in the marshlands, steeped in utterly pointless treatises, and who do not trust in the

tathāgatagarbha, still do not understand that 'selflessness' is a word spoken with a hidden intent; so these beings of the marshlands do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha. In the future too, those of the marshlands who, attached to utterly pointless treatises, do not understand what was spoken in veiled terms and do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are surely those of the marshlands who do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha.

"Those beings who formerly lay at any door at all, base thieves, are called dog-like. In the future too, the beings who roam into other people's homes and do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are base like dogs.

"Those beings who formerly were cats, always attached to eating meat, and who do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha, are still attached to meat, and they become rākṣasas who take life, transformed into the shape of cats. In the future too, the beings who are rākṣasas transformed into the shape of cats, who take the lives of others and eat flesh, the merciless ones who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha, are no others: they are the rākṣasas who take the lives of others and eat flesh, transformed into the shape of cats.

"Those beings who were rats and eunuchs, who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha, still drink liquor and have become rats and eunuchs; they drink what is utterly impure. In the future too, the beings who drink liquor and are base like eunuchs, sated with worldly tastes, do not want the tathāgatagarbha; they are no others, and they should be regarded as those who were eunuchs and rats.

"Those beings who were jackals, shameless and wickedly deceitful, who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha, still do not understand that the tathāgatagarbha was explained in intentional speech, and they have become deceitful beings like jackals. In the future too, the beings who do not understand that the tathāgatagarbha was explained in intentional speech and who wrongly imagine, 'This is permitted,' are surely those who were jackals.

"Those beings who formerly were ugly creeping things, scorpions, and who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha, still blaze up when they hear of the tathāgatagarbha, and their hearts fill with hatred; they are surely like scorpions. In the future too, the beings who, on hearing of the tathāgatagarbha, do not trust it, saying, 'The Buddha did not teach this,' are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are surely those who, like scorpions, do burning deeds.

"Those beings who formerly were snakes of unending venom and who speak without praise of the tathāgatagarbha are still greatly arrogant, and they become snakes of fearsome form and unending venom. In the future too, the beings who speak without praise of the tathāgatagarbha, a teaching for the benefit of others, and who act wickedly, are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are surely the snakes of unending venom.

"Those beings who formerly were sheep, stupid and dull-witted, not knowing the qualities of human beings, who do not revere the tathāgatagarbha and who disparage the sūtras, still disparage the sūtras; those beings are surely those who were sheep, stupid and dull-witted. In the future too, the beings who sleep much and who disparage the tathāgatagarbha on hearing of it are no others: they are surely the dull-witted and feeble.

"Those beings who formerly were dull-witted buffaloes and who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha are still surely clinging and greedy; they are like buffaloes made obstinate by the three views. In the future too, the beings who are greedy, given to anger, and dull-witted, and who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha, are no others: they are surely the buffaloes made obstinate by the three views.

"Those beings who formerly were bears turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha and do not trust in it; those beings still proclaim what is unpleasant, and they are surely like bears and jackals. In the future too, the beings who turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha and proclaim what is unpleasant are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are like bears and jackals.

"Those who formerly were kalandaka birds turn their backs on the tathāgatagarbha and do not trust in it; and still now, the beings who are dull-eyed have surely become kalandaka birds. In the future too, the beings who conceal knowledge of the tathāgatagarbha and, being vicious, commit evil deeds are no others: whoever does not teach the tathāgatagarbha is surely a dull-eyed kalandaka bird.

"Those who formerly were donkeys, who formed the thought that the tathāgatagarbha is of no use, will still now be poor and, like donkeys, eat coarse food. In the future too they will be born poor, into a low caste, sent on errands by others. Those who do not trust in the tathāgatagarbha and meditate on selflessness are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are like the lustful, outcastes (caṇḍālas), fowlers, and donkeys.

"Those who formerly were asuras, short of body, long-fanged, ugly, like a squat trunk, and who disparaged the tathāgatagarbha, are still now short of body and like a squat trunk; they are surely asuras. In the future too, the beings who are squat like a trunk, short, long-fanged and fierce, and who disparage the tathāgatagarbha, are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are beings belonging to the class of the asuras.

"Those who formerly became hungry ghosts with flames issuing from their mouths, the beings who reviled and scorned the tathāgatagarbha, still now have dry lips and palates, and become creatures, emaciated hungry ghosts with flames issuing from their mouths. In the future too, the beings whose bodies are utterly emaciated and who revile and scorn the tathāgatagarbha are no others, Venerable Pūrṇa: they are surely feeble hungry ghosts with flames issuing from their mouths.

"Formerly too, those beings who regarded the permanent body of the Tathāgata as impermanent became afflicted with leprosy; and still now, the beings who are weak and afflicted with leprosy surely disparage the permanent body of the Tathāgata. In the future too, the beings who regard the permanent body of the Tathāgata as impermanent and become afflicted with leprosy are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they disparage the permanent body of the Tathāgata.

"Formerly, those who regarded the peaceful body of the Tathāgata as not peaceful became grossly bloated; and still now, those who are bloated and weak surely regard the peaceful body of the Tathāgata as not peaceful. In the future too, the beings who regard the peaceful body of the Tathāgata as not peaceful are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, those grossly bloated ones surely repudiate the peaceful body of the Tathāgata.

"Those who formerly fell into decline in a time of prosperity, the many kinds of beings beset by many illnesses, are those who regarded the eternal body of the Tathāgata as not eternal. Still now, the beings who fall into decline in a time of prosperity are those who regard the eternal body of the Tathāgata as not eternal. In the future too, the beings who fall into decline in a time of prosperity are those who regard the eternal body of the Tathāgata as not eternal; Venerable Pūrṇa, they are surely no others: they repudiate the luminous body of the Tathāgata, saying that it is not luminous.

"The beings who formerly regarded the everlasting body of the Tathāgata as not everlasting were born in the womb of a king's noble queen, and died, and

were impermanent. Still now, whatever beings are born in the womb of a king's noble queen and die surely disparage the everlasting and luminous body of the Tathāgata. In the future too, the beings who are impermanent and short-lived disparage the everlasting body; Venerable Pūrṇa, they are no others: they surely disparage the everlasting body of the Tathāgata.

"The beings who formerly were without sons are also those who held to impermanence, saying, 'The Tathāgata has passed completely into nirvāṇa like a fire whose fuel is spent.' Still now, the beings who are without sons regard nirvāṇa as destruction. In the future too, the vicious beings without sons are those who regard the Tathāgata's complete nirvāṇa as destruction; they are no others, Venerable Pūrṇa: they are surely those who regard the Tathāgata's complete nirvāṇa as destruction.

"The beings who formerly imagined the Tathāgata to be born from the union of father and mother became separated from father and mother. Still now, the beings who are separated from father and mother surely disparage the Tathāgata. In the future too, the beings who regard the Buddha as born from the union of father and mother will be without father and mother; they are no others, Venerable Pūrṇa: they are those separated from father and mother who disparage the Tathāgata.

"The beings who formerly said falsely, 'The body of the Tathāgata is a human body with bones, sinews, marrow and blood,' and who turned their backs on his acting in conformity with the world, became beings with repulsive defects in the world. Still now, those beings lack some of their limbs, have foul-smelling mouths, and turn their backs entirely on his acting in conformity with the world. In the future too, the beings whose mouths stink with an impure, unpleasant smell, who are lame, crippled on one side, and lacking in limbs, and who turn their backs on his acting in conformity with the world, are no others: Venerable Pūrṇa, they are shunned by the whole world.

"The deeds of all the beings described above are utterly terrifying. Even if they obtain birth in the human state, they will meet with all the inconceivable sufferings of the world. They will be destined for the sufferings of birth as animals and of the world of Yama. Through what they themselves have done, they experience ignorance and remain in it for a long time; and for those who turn their backs on the Tathāgata, whose very nature is great qualities, even a mustard seed's worth of virtue is hard to find.

"Those who formerly pleased many tathāgatas and, having heard of the greatness of the Tathāgata, held to it even for the space of a finger snap, by that root of virtue those beings come to have tamed senses, and to be wealthy and of great family.

"And now too, those beings who have tamed senses and are householders with many servants and dependents, like great sāl trees, and those who have become great brahmin families, delight in the tathāgatagarbha merely by its touching their ears, and they abundantly perform meritorious deeds. In the future too, the beings who, having heard of the tathāgatagarbha, practice it just as it is, and those people who have many servants and dependents and are of great family, are no others: they are beings who have made merit. They will be prosperous and agreeable to the mind, perfect in form, complexion, strength and dignity, endowed with intelligence, mindfulness and a keen mind, pleasant of voice and a joy to behold. They will become kings, ministers, princes and wheel-turning monarchs, and likewise virtuous beings free of pride, who have overcome sleep and are careful and conscientious; and they will become, among others, those who enjoy the perfections of the heavens and of the earth: lords of the gods, lords of Brahmā, world protectors and the like. Through the cause, the merit of hearing of the tathāgatagarbha, they will be free of illness, free of harm and long-lived, and all beings will delight in them. By hearing that the Tathāgata is permanent, eternal and everlasting, and that even his complete nirvāṇa is deathless, they will be wholly prosperous, steadfast for a long time, and permanent.

"Those who know that the Buddha, by acting in conformity with the whole world, is displaying a play, and who teach that the Tathāgata is not born from sexual union, will, through the merit of having found wisdom and good qualities, have many children and find that their fathers and mothers live long. Through the cause of knowing that the permanent tathāgatagarbha is present in all sentient beings, they will find all the supreme kinds of happiness in the world and every perfection there is. By hearing that the tathāgatagarbha is permanent, they will always obtain, in the past, the present and the future, in all three times, every perfection and all the happiness of the heavens and of the earth.

"Through the cause of having despised the tathāgatagarbha, one will lack limbs in all the abodes of the five destinies, and wandering in suffering saṃsāra, will experience suffering. The beings who have honored and served the buddhas, and the beings who teach what is beneficial and who themselves

reflect on the tathāgatagarbha, will find the hearing of the tathāgatagarbha.

"Venerable Pūrṇa, the beings who have turned their backs on many buddhas, the beings who revile the tathāgatagarbha when they hear of it, burn their own seed; alas, they are to be lamented inconceivably throughout the three times!

"One who wishes to teach the Dharma should teach it in this way: one should highly praise the Tathāgata as permanent and as reality itself. Those who do not teach thus, and who cast aside the tathāgatagarbha, are like an outcaste seated on the king's elephant: the lion throne is not fitting for them either.

"Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found a tathāgatagarbha that has been born; in all sentient beings there is the unborn buddha element, adorned with the excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have themselves searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found an element that has come into being; in all sentient beings there is the element that has not come into being, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have themselves searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found an impermanent element; in all sentient beings there is the permanent element, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found a tathāgatagarbha that is not everlasting; in all sentient beings there is the everlasting element, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found a tathāgatagarbha that is not eternal; in all sentient beings there is the eternal element, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found illness in the tathāgatagarbha; in all sentient beings there is the element free of illness, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found aging and death in the tathāgatagarbha; in all sentient beings there is the element free of aging and death, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found a tathāgatagarbha that is fearful; the fearless element, the buddha element, an element adorned

with the endless excellent major and minor marks, is present in all sentient beings. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found a tathāgatagarbha that can be destroyed; the indestructible element, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks, is present in all sentient beings. Though all the buddhas have searched with the utmost diligence, they have not found stain in the tathāgatagarbha; in all sentient beings there is the stainless element, the buddha element, an element adorned with the endless excellent major and minor marks.

"Just as, for example, water and oil, when mixed, cannot be perceived as one, so too, although the buddha element is covered by tens of millions of afflictions, there is no way that the afflictions and the buddha element could become mixed. Although the element dwells within tens of millions of afflictions, it is like a lamp that dwells inside a pot: when the pot is broken, the lamp blazes forth and is beautiful. The one who teaches the tathāgatagarbha is a perfect buddha. Or else, the śrāvaka of a perfect buddha is like the pot, and freedom from affliction is like the lamp; whoever teaches the tathāgatagarbha, whether still with afflictions or free of afflictions, whoever it may be, that very one is called a perfect buddha.

"Venerable Pūrṇa, when those who have entered the path of liberation break the tens of millions of afflictions as one breaks a pot, then at last they see the whole element like an emblic fruit in the palm of the hand. For example, when the moon and the sun are covered by clouds, they do not appear upon the earth, but when they are freed from the clouds, the moon and the sun appear upon the earth. In the same way, when the tathāgatagarbha is covered by tens of millions of afflictions, it does not appear; but when, like the moon and the sun, it is freed from the afflictions, the sun and moon of the buddha element appear as well.

"Alas, Venerable Pūrṇa, you behave as a fly behaves, and you do not know how to give a talk on the Dharma. A fly also makes a sound: is that knowing, too? Without speaking a second time, fly, go away quickly!"

Then the elder Sundarananda bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I too rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and considerate. Now aspire to the form of a buddha, and, brahmin, come to know it in that way."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to Sundarananda: "Venerable Sundarananda, since you are supreme among the handsome, who in the world is truly handsome? How do people's forms become beautiful and fine? Speak quickly and cut through my doubt!"

Then Sundarananda said to Aṅgulimāla:

"One who washes well his hands and joins his ten fingers in reverence,
Who bows down at the feet of the Tathāgata,
And who always tends to those who are sick:
From that a person comes to be handsome."

Aṅgulimāla in turn said to Sundarananda: "The Tathāgata has no bones and no sinews; how then could he have bodily remains and relics? The one without relics, the dharmakāya supreme in means, is the inconceivable buddha; the Tathāgata is inconceivable. In order to generate faith in those without faith, he employed the means of leaving relics: he left relics so that stūpas of the Buddha would be built. That is the nature of the buddhas. The many kinds of costumed and adorned images of the world's Brahmā, Īśvara, Kātyāyanī and the youth Skanda, which are made and set up in image houses and in brick dwellings, are thereby made to be no refuge. One who knows that the bodily remains of the Tathāgata are thus a means is the handsome person in the world. It is through that root, the wisdom of means, that form becomes beautiful; any other conception is a childish wandering. Sundarananda, you do not even know the gateway to becoming fine in form. Alas, Venerable Sundarananda, you behave as a fly behaves, and do not even know the gateway from which form arises. A fly too has excellent form, so you who are like a fly, say nothing!"

Then the elder Upāli bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I too rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and considerate. Aṅgulimāla, now apply yourself to the Vinaya."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said to the elder Upāli: "Venerable Upāli, since you are supreme among the holders of the Vinaya, who in the world is a holder of the Vinaya? How is one skilled in laying down the Vinaya? Speak quickly and cut through my doubt!"

Then the elder Upāli said this to Aṅgulimāla:

"Do not commit any evil;
Bring virtue to perfection;
Tame your own mind completely.
That, for all the buddhas,
Is the essence of the Vinaya in brief."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to the elder Upāli: "The possessions of the corrupt and outrageous, their robes and so forth, their books, alms bowls, water strainers, belts and needles, should in every case all be forbidden to them and taken away; those who do not comply should be punished and dealt with sternly. All of that is the property of those who keep moral discipline; it is not the property of the corrupt and outrageous. For example, if a king's sword is lying in an outcaste's house, there is no fault even in seizing it by force, for it is not the outcaste's property but the king's treasure. In the same way, that is the property of those who keep moral discipline, and one who seizes it and carries it off forcibly is the holder of the Vinaya in the world. For him there is not even a transgression as small as a minor misdeed. Nor is it contrary to the proper procedure, for it is the fulfillment of the Tathāgata's command. The Tathāgata always regards all sentient beings as equal to Rāhula. Alas, Venerable Upāli behaves as a fly behaves, and does not know the essence of the Vinaya in brief. Even a fly knows what is to be done, so you who are like a fly, say nothing!"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent! Aṅgulimāla, I too rejoice that you have made merit that is fitting and considerate. Now you should meditate on phenomena as the great emptiness, in which nothing whatsoever exists."

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, since you are supreme among those who see the great emptiness, who in the world is one who sees emptiness? What is the meaning of the words 'empty, empty'? You who have great knowledge, speak quickly and swiftly cut through my doubt!"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī spoke to Aṅgulimāla in verse:

"The Buddha is like space;
Space is without characteristics.
The Buddha is like space;
Space is born from signlessness.
The Buddha is like space;

Space has become formless.

Phenomena are like space;
The Tathāgata is the body of Dharma.
Wisdom is like space;
The Tathāgata is the body of wisdom.
Ungraspable and intangible,
Wisdom without attachment is the Tathāgata.
Liberation is like space;
Space, too, has no characteristics.
Liberation is the Buddha, the Tathāgata.
Emptiness, nothingness:
Aṅgulimāla, how could you know them?"

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Suppose, for example, that heavy rain falls from a great cloud, and a man of childish nature picks up some hailstones and, thinking them to be precious vaiḍūrya gems, carries them home. Since they are far too cold for him to hold, he thinks, 'I shall keep them as a treasure,' and places them carefully inside a jar. Then, seeing the hailstones melt away, he thinks, 'It is empty,' and falls silent. In the same way, Venerable Mañjuśrī, by meditating intensely on emptiness and pondering deeply on what is empty, you see all phenomena as destroyed, without any that does not perish. You even see and conceive liberation, which is not empty, as empty. Just as, for example, one who imagines hailstones to be jewels then meditates on the jewel as empty too, so you too think of phenomena that are not empty as empty: having seen phenomena that are empty, you destroy, as empty, even the phenomena that are not empty. Empty phenomena are one thing, and phenomena that are not empty are another. Like hailstones, the tens of millions of afflictions are empty. Like hailstones, the phenomena on the side of non-virtue quickly perish. Like a vaiḍūrya gem, the Buddha is permanent, and the culmination of liberation, too, is like a vaiḍūrya gem.

"Space too is the form of the buddhas, while all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are formless. The liberation of the buddhas is also form, while the liberation of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas is formless. So how can the characteristic of liberation be called empty? Do not conceive of them as indistinguishable!

"Mañjuśrī, an empty house in a built-up town is empty because there are no people in it. A jar is empty because there is no water in it. A riverbed is empty because no water flows in it. Is the space between houses in a town, where there are no houses, what is called 'empty, empty'? Are all houses empty? Not all are empty; it is called empty because there are no people in it. Are all jars empty? Not all are empty; it is called empty because there is no water in it. Are all rivers empty? Not all are empty; it is called empty because no water flows in it. In the same way, liberation is not empty of everything; liberation is called empty because it is free of all faults. The Buddha, the Blessed One, is not empty; he is called empty because he is free of all faults and devoid of the people and gods that are the tens of millions of afflictions.

"Alas, Venerable Mañjuśrī behaves as a fly behaves, and does not know the very meaning of empty and not empty. The Nirgranthas (naked ascetics) too meditate on everything as empty; so you, fly of the Nirgranthas, say nothing!"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī in turn said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Aṅgulimāla, since you kill all the śrāvakas like a tiger in the wilderness, do not despise the children of the Tathāgata in that way! Fly, who are you?"

Then Aṅgulimāla in turn said this to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "For example, when wretched vagrants, starving like hungry ghosts, are traveling on the road, at the mere smell of a tiger they flee in all directions. In the same way the śrāvakas, because they do not know the Great Vehicle, flee in all directions like vagrants when they smell the scent of a bodhisattva. For example, when the king of lions roars with a lion's might in the mountain wilds, the deer, jackals and all the rest, on hearing the lion's roar, cannot survive and die. In the same way, when a bodhisattva roars the lion's roar and overpowers with a lion's might, then, on hearing the bodhisattva's voice, all the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are utterly bewildered by its hidden meaning. Since none of the śrāvakas can reply even when I merely give a jackal's cry for a while, what would become of the śrāvakas if I were to roar the lion's roar?"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī in turn said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Who are you, who are like a fly? Aṅgulimāla has done extremely savage deeds. If even someone like you is a bodhisattva, what are the likes of Māra the Evil One like? Alas, worldly people do not know themselves: they do not see their own faults, but they see the faults of others. How many evil deeds has Aṅgulimāla done!"

Then Aṅgulimāla said this to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Alas, in the world there are two kinds of person who destroy the true Dharma: one who holds the view

of utter emptiness, and one who in the world proclaims a self. These two destroy the true Dharma and overturn the true Dharma. Alas, Venerable Mañjuśrī does not know what is evil and what is not evil! Alas, he does not even know the conduct of a bodhisattva! Alas, if he thinks the tigers among bodhisattvas are not to be feared, alas, Venerable Mañjuśrī does not know even the difference between a fly and a lion!

"Venerable Mañjuśrī, listen to the conduct of bodhisattvas praised by the Tathāgata. For example, a king of illusionists, in the midst of an assembly gathered for a magic show, displays cutting and chopping; the illusionist displays eating and also being caught in a snare. Just like the illusions of the illusionist, the supreme among illusionists, who performs illusions of many kinds, so too is the teaching of the buddhas: the tigers among bodhisattvas also display many kinds of illusion, such as their own birth and complete nirvāṇa. In an intermediate eon of disease, thinking, 'I am free of illness,' they become the supreme food for the sake of beings who are sick. In an intermediate eon of fire they burn up the lands and teach impermanence to beings who perceive things as permanent. In an intermediate eon of weapons, thinking, 'I teach for the sake of beings,' they turn everything into weapons and iron; and though the buddhas display mutual slaughter, not a single being is harmed, for these are like illusory emanations.

"A buddha can place even an entire great trichiliocosm inside a hollow mustard seed, and no being whatsoever is harmed. He also shows himself taking it out again and setting it back in its place just as it was. Though the waters of the ocean, the masses of water, the masses of mountains, Mount Meru and the rest enter a single pore of a buddha, not a single being is troubled, and afterward he sets them back each in its own direction. Though he makes the world systems of the ten directions quake with his big toe, not a single being is troubled: that is the activity of the buddhas, which is their very nature. In whatever way beings may be benefited, he becomes even a servant or a disciple. Likewise he becomes a villager, a caravan leader, or a chaplain. Among kings, ministers, youths, village headmen and every kind of gathering, he adapts himself and conforms to them in order to benefit beings. He becomes all the gods too, showing birth among them all in order to reverse their views; that is why they are called the birth stories.

"When people see an illusionist's illusions, they do not declare to the whole assembly, 'Alas, the illusionist is evil: he cuts and chops, and kills others!' In the same way, the Buddha too should be regarded as having the nature of an

illusionist in the world, and my killing of beings should be understood in the same way. Just as an illusionist conjures an illusory man, so too one thousand nine hundred and ninety-nine illusory emanations were conjured by the power of taming beings of that kind. Mañjuśrī, just as in an intermediate eon of weapons, I too have emanated these illusions of bodhisattva conduct. Alas, Venerable Mañjuśrī behaves as a fly behaves: though he knows the great elephant among men, he will not acknowledge him. One who knows yet will not acknowledge is like a fly, and is called contemptible."

Then the Blessed One, who knows all and sees all, said this to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, it is just as Aṅgulimāla says: such is the conduct of a bodhisattva. Mañjuśrī, this Aṅgulimāla is no ordinary person; through the power of taming beings of that kind, the bodhisattva, the great elephant among men, has emanated himself in this way. Mañjuśrī, wait a moment: Aṅgulimāla too is like you. I shall teach the great nature of Aṅgulimāla in full detail; from that account, come to know the greatness of Aṅgulimāla."

Then the Blessed One said this to Aṅgulimāla: "Excellent, excellent, great elephant among men, that you have shown diligence for the benefit of all beings! Quickly bring yourself to attain arhatship, and, for the benefit and happiness of all beings, you should tell them: 'Its qualities are like this; its deeds are like this; its diligence is like this.'"

The fourth fascicle.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, out of your wish to benefit all beings and your love for them, please explain, for the benefit and happiness of all beings: 'The qualities of one who wishes to attain arhatship in this very body are like this; the deeds are like this; the diligence is like this.'"

The Blessed One said: "When the father and mother come together, and in due time a child is conceived in the mother's womb, as soon as the child is conceived the father and mother become joyful. Through the qualities gained from what he himself has undergone, their diligence and splendor become different. The world too becomes prosperous and abundant; the world becomes free of strife; the king too becomes very happy. The mother also has dreams of excellent merit, and when the boy is born, even those who were unfriendly become very loving, saying, 'The family will prosper.' When the boy reaches seven, eight or nine years of age and enters the writing school, no fighting or quarreling arises in the household; the male and female servants

too become delighted and content, and through honest work they make the household prosper. When the boy reaches twenty years of age, the household's cattle, buffaloes, sheep and other four-footed animals do not fight either, and they become as dear as father and mother. The cows give abundant curd.

"In that boy there is no lust, jealousy, spite, dishonesty, deceit, lying, harsh speech, childish behavior or improper conduct, and none of the deeds on the side of non-virtue arise. He gives rise to the wish to honor his father and mother and to honor his teacher and preceptor. When he sees elders, he joins his palms. When he sees those of middle age, he embraces them warmly. When he plays children's games with boys and girls like himself, he thinks of giving, of showing respect and of sharing. He treats the destitute like his own children. In all that he does he has a sense of shame, and is fearful and wary of wrongdoing. He delights in the activities of the true Dharma; he does not delight in dancing and conjuring. He does not indulge in sleep and idleness. He wishes to see the Buddha and always reads the scriptures. He delights in the trainings and in many kinds of craft; he does not delight in dice, games or drinking liquor. He is honored by the virtuous people devoted to the service of the gods. He has overcome sleep. He does not eat much. He is not lacking in cleanliness. All beings outside, too, take delight in him. He has great courage and great intelligence in the activities of the Dharma. Because he has a great many such qualities, he attains arhatship in that very body. Such are the qualities, such the deeds, and such the forms of diligence.

"Śāriputra, Aṅgulimāla too will quickly attain arhatship; how then could Aṅgulimāla be evil? Śāriputra, Aṅgulimāla also has other marvels and qualities: just as Mañjuśrī is, so too is Aṅgulimāla, the bodhisattva, the elephant among men. Aṅgulimāla looks upon all beings as on an only child. The bodhisattva, the great being Aṅgulimāla, having freed himself, frees the whole world.

"'Having crossed over, I shall bring others across': for his own sake and for the sake of the world, this person constantly makes that aspiration. That one who benefits the whole world and is loving toward it should do evil is impossible. For the sake of such beings the bodhisattvas, the elephants among men, become like the sun, like the moon, like Brahmā, and become Prajāpati (the Lord of Creatures). They become earth, wind, space, water, and fire as the fifth, and they become many such forms."

Then the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, Aṅgulimāla is a noble person. The very moment he saw the Blessed One, he himself definitively crossed beyond all existence."

Then Aṅgulimāla said to the elder Mahāmaudgalyāyana, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, if the Tathāgata were not to be found, what beings would there be in the world who are masters of the Dharma?"

He said, "Son of good family, the Blessed One taught in the scripture of the Abhidharma: 'Monks, there are three sick people, three who are like the sick. Which are the three sick? The one called wrongly determined, the one called rightly determined, and the undetermined person.' Now, who is wrongly determined? The one called wrongly determined is a person whom even the Tathāgata cannot tame. The one called rightly determined is, for example, someone like the venerable Mañjuśrī or Mahākāśyapa, who, even while no Tathāgata had appeared, fully entered the Dharma of suchness for the Tathāgata's sake."

He said, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, do not say in this way that, before the Tathāgata was born, the venerable elder Mahākāśyapa entered the Dharma of suchness by himself. Why is that? The Tathāgata is permanent, and in the homes of those who abide in the Dharma, that Tathāgata dwells. For example, all rivers arise from rain. Even when there is no rain, if water flows, the wise think about it in this way: 'That water should flow without rain is impossible, so it should be understood that rain is falling elsewhere, and it should be understood that the river flows from that.' In the same way, Maudgalyāyana, all supreme dharmas, worldly and transcendent, flow down from the Buddha. Therefore it should be understood that the venerable Mahākāśyapa too went forth at the feet of the Tathāgata.

"If it is asked how it is that not all people see this magical display: Venerable one, is it not the Blessed One alone who knows it? It is like rain having fallen elsewhere. Therefore it should be understood that beings in a time when there is no buddha also do not definitively liberate themselves; rather, they are always definitively liberated in the direct presence of the Buddha.

"Moreover, venerable one, suppose some person, having seen the moon and the sun, goes inside a house and thinks, 'Those two do not see me.' Do the moon and the sun not see him? They do see him, but the unwise man, as soon as he has gone inside the house, thinks, 'The moon and the sun do not see me.' In the same way, venerable Maudgalyāyana, do not speak like that

unwise man. The Tathāgata always definitively liberates beings; he always causes beings to go forth and to take full ordination. Therefore persons are either wrongly determined or rightly determined; there is no third, called undetermined."

He said, "Worldly people also have the five precepts, and they exist at the time when a buddha appears as well."

He said, "Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, do not say that. Whatever moral discipline, rites, and virtues in accord with the Dharma there are in the world, whether worldly or transcendent, all of them, in every case, should be understood as the word of the Buddha."

He said, "There is a threefold account concerning those like the sick. Some sick people live if they find a physician. Some sick people live even without finding a physician. Some sick people do not live even though they find a physician."

He said, "The sick are not of three kinds. Some sick people live even without finding a physician; some sick people do not live even though they find a physician. They are of two kinds: the curable and the incurable."

He said, "They are not three. Some sick people live even without finding a physician. Some sick people do not live even though they find a physician and an attendant: if there is no medicine, what can even a physician do? The sick person who lives even without finding a physician, how would he not live if he did find a physician? For it is not through a single cause that one knows the work of a physician: such a person knows neither the regimen of abstaining from food nor what is to be given up. If he knows none of these, he will die an untimely death. Therefore sick people are curable or incurable: even when a physician has been found, and medicine and an attendant have been found, if the patient dies, that becomes a case where it was of no avail. Why is that? If medicine, attendant, and physician are all not found, or a physician is found but medicine is not found, and so, if one does not live even after finding a physician and medicine, then there is no distinction between medicine and physician either. Why? Because all the procedures for making the body heavy and light come from the science of life (Āyurveda). Therefore, venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, what is curable is curable, and what is incurable is incurable; there is no threefold conceiving in three ways. That is the knowledge of the śrāvakas, and the wise call it knowledge like that of a fly.

"For the sake of the unwise it is conceived in two ways. Of these, the one called wrongly determined is the icchantika (one of great desire); the one called rightly determined is the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

"Venerable Maudgalyāyana, there are two kinds of marvel. Which two? The Tathāgata and the icchantika. The Tathāgata is a marvel in the highest state: no state higher than the Tathāgata is seen, and that is a marvel. In the lowest state too, nothing other than the icchantika is seen. For example, just as the Tathāgata's śrāvakas go about bringing the ten perfections to completion, in the same way the icchantika too goes about bringing the ten perfections to completion. For example, just as the Tathāgata's śrāvakas, in the perfection of generosity, give away their own sons, their eyes, and their flesh, in heaps of tens of millions larger than Mount Meru, and more besides, in the same way the icchantika too brings to completion the ten perfections, the icchantika's perfection of generosity.

"When the icchantika goes to the world of the hungry ghosts, a lustful mind arises in him there. Then many women quickly appear, and many sons appear as well. How could he obtain even happiness by mere thought? Then the thought of eating his own sons quickly arises, and he eats them. Again, through his karma he takes on the form of a brahmin; he gives the sons to beggars, and then eats those he has given. And he himself eats everything. In this way the icchantika too completes the icchantika's perfection of generosity, and in the same way he brings the ten perfections to completion. Therefore the supreme among high states is the buddhas, the blessed ones, and in the low state are the icchantikas. Venerable Maudgalyāyana, thus there are two kinds of marvel. Consider that the wrongly determined person is the icchantika. Consider that the rightly determined person is the Tathāgata and the Tathāgata's śrāvakas."

Then the Blessed One said to Aṅgulimāla, "Aṅgulimāla, come here! Quickly go forth, and take up the threefold going for refuge."

Then Aṅgulimāla replied to the Blessed One in verse:

"This vehicle is the Great Vehicle;
It is also called unattached wisdom.
The single vehicle is the single refuge;
The Tathāgata is the ultimate refuge.
The Dharma and the Buddha are one in meaning;
The Tathāgata is the Dharma body.

The Saṅgha is a name of the Tathāgata;
The Saṅgha itself is the Tathāgata.
The Dharma and the Saṅgha, these two, are refuges of skillful means;
The Tathāgata is the refuge beyond means, the ultimate refuge.
The Tathāgata is the refuge of those without refuge;
Therefore I go for refuge to the Tathāgata.
Just as one who wants to eat asafoetida, saying, 'Asafoetida is what I must eat,'
Throws away real asafoetida and eats imitation asafoetida,
In this world it does him no good, nor is his illness cured;
A thousand physicians cannot cure such a senseless person of the world.
In the same way, those who utterly abandon the single refuge
And enter into refuges of skillful means:
There is no other fly like that,
And a thousand buddhas cannot cure him."

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, keep the moral discipline of a youth."

Then Aṅgulimāla again said to the Blessed One, "What in the world is a youth? What is full ordination? What in the world is a manifest śramaṇa? What in the world is one worthy of offerings?"

Then the Blessed One remained silent, and Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, those in the world who do not know the single refuge as the ultimate refuge are set in the two means. Those two are refuges in the world. One who has become a youth but whose full ordination is not manifest: is he a śramaṇa? Those who do not know the single refuge, how could they even apply refuge? Those who do not know the Blessed One as the ultimate refuge, if they have not trained in going for refuge from the very beginning, how could they be śramaṇas? If they do not clearly know going for refuge in this way, how could they be worthy of offerings? Whoever does not know the difference between refuge and the refuge of skillful means is an unskilled youth in the world."

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, keep the moral discipline of abandoning killing."

Then Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "I do not hold the moral discipline of abandoning killing; like a fisherman, I hold the moral discipline of killing. What

is called life is the ten million afflictions; whoever seizes them and kills them, that is what holding to the abandonment of killing means in the world. Those I shall kill, or else, destroying their arrogance, I shall make them my disciples."

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, take up the moral discipline of abandoning false speech."

Aṅgulimāla again said to the Blessed One, "I do not hold the moral discipline of abandoning false speech. All dharmas are untrue, and I teach the Dharma that speaks untruth. That is the true nature of the Buddha, and it is called untrue. All dharmas are empty, and all the dharmas called arhat are also called false. The conduct of śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and bodhisattvas, which conforms to the world and follows it, is also called untrue dharma. 'I was born in the world, went forth, and took full ordination; I attained arhatship. I made use of the gifts of others. I walk about in the world. I attend to what my nine openings require. I do not know the gods. I take up a tooth stick. I apply eye ointment. I meditate. I keep off sleep. I shave my head. I get into bed and lie down. A pain arose in my back. A disorder of phlegm, of bile, of wind, and of their combination arose, and I drank medicine. I pass into complete nirvāṇa like a fire whose fuel is spent': all such dharmas are untrue. So long as I engage in whatever is done by skillful means, in what is done by skillful means in the world, I do not practice the moral discipline concerning false speech.

"I shall explain the Dharma of suchness, the Dharma of truth; listen to me! Venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the tathāgatagarbha, the truth, reality itself; the ultimate body, the permanent body; the inconceivable body of the Tathāgata; the ultimate body; the eternal body, the permanent body; the ultimate body; the Dharma body; the body of peace; the ultimate body; the Dharma body; the body born from suchness itself: how is that taught? Therefore it comes about through untrue dharma. All the teachings of the Blessed One are free of untruth; therefore he is called the Buddha.

"For example, cowherds make the hide of a dead calf look like a calf, lead it along, and so get the cow to accept it as another calf. In the same way, when he follows the world and acts in accord with it, the Buddha teaches the Dharma as if he were deaf. Like the cowherds and the cow, the deaf too think, 'Our Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, who is also deaf, has appeared in the world, and we too are deaf,' and they rejoice greatly.

"They think that the Blessed One too is deaf, and they think, 'We too shall become foremost in the world.' By this he spurs them on toward the very state

of the Dharma of suchness. The Tathāgata, who establishes all the dharmas of the world in the Dharma, the Tathāgata, is beautiful. If the real calf were shown again, the cow would neither let herself be milked nor accept it; so the cowherd shows the calf being fed, gives a handful of grass, and tames her by means of something untrue. In the same way, if the Buddha had already shown in the world the ultimate body, his essential nature, who would be able to see that body? Just as with the bundle of grass for the cow, he follows the whole world, and so the dharmas he teaches are not true. Therefore the buddhas in the world, by whatever means they lead beings to take up the Dharma, bring many beings to maturity; that is the very nature of the buddhas. For that reason I too practice untrue dharma: insofar as all beings are untrue, to that extent I too do not hold to the dharma of abandoning false speech. Then my moral discipline becomes completely pure."

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, take up the moral discipline of abandoning the drinking of liquor."

Then Aṅgulimāla again replied to the Blessed One in verse:

"I do not hold the discipline of giving up liquor;
I hold the discipline of the intoxication born from liquor.
Drinking liquor is said to give rise to pride;
To go and walk about always in great bliss is what I call liquor.
The essence of the Sugata is born from the Great Vehicle;
Having drunk its nectar, a person becomes sated.
'The Tathāgata is permanent, stable, eternal':
Overjoyed and sated, laughing 'ha ha,' saying 'Excellent!'
May I attain that perfection!"

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, take up the moral discipline of abandoning sexual intercourse."

Then Aṅgulimāla again spoke to the Blessed One in verse:

"I do not hold the precept of abandoning intercourse;
I always hold to lustful attachment to the women of others.
Like a banner, I frequent the house of the courtesan;
I am deeply attached even in the presence of all women.
The taste of meditative absorption is my wife;
Delight in other dharmas is attachment to the women of others.
Heroism and delight in truth are my sons;
Compassion and loving-kindness are my many daughters;

This emptiness is my house;
The boundless perfections are my bed;
The afflictions are my servants;
My food is teaching the secret of intentional speech.
My pleasure grove is the dhāraṇīs,
Adorned with the flowers of the limbs of awakening;
The wisdom of liberation is its fruit,
And my words of Dharma are its trunk.
These and others are the supreme delights of the household life.
This is not the domain of the childish;
This is the natural Dharma of the wise."

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, take up the moral discipline of abandoning taking what is not given."

Then Aṅgulimāla again replied to the Blessed One in verse:

"I do not hold the precept of giving up taking what is not given;
I always hold to the way of stealing the wealth of others.
What is not given is called awakening:
It has never been given by anyone to anyone.
Even when the Blessed One sat at the foot of the tree of awakening,
You found nothing, and nothing was destroyed.
That is the nature of all dharmas;
That is the unsurpassed Dharma."

The Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, take up the moral discipline of abandoning dancing and music."

Then Aṅgulimāla again spoke to the Blessed One in verse:

"Like a dancer, I am always dancing;
Proclaiming the sweet melodies of the gandharvas, I sing songs and dance,
And teach, 'Excellent, excellent!' the essence of the Tathāgata.
Speaking praises, I dance, having heard of the essence of the Tathāgata.
As if bestowing it on people, I recite the Great Vehicle sūtras with sweet sound;
With the drums and small drums of kinnaras and gandharvas,
And with cymbals, I make offerings to the sacred volumes as well.
Those beings who always make offerings in this way,
One after another in the world, all bearing a single name,
Will become buddhas in the future: so the Tathāgata has declared."

Then the Blessed One said, "Then, Aṅgulimāla, learn 'What is one? What is...'"

Aṅgulimāla again said to the Blessed One, "'What is one?' 'All beings subsist on food': that is a saying that comes from the Śrāvaka Vehicle; in the Great Vehicle there is nothing of that kind. Followers of the Great Vehicle are always unblinking and steadfast. What is one? All beings abide in the tathāgatagarbha. What is two? The phrase 'name and form' comes from the Śrāvaka Vehicle, not from the Great Vehicle. Name and form are like this: name and form are not of some other kind. The liberation of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas is a mere name; they do not know its form and shape. The liberation of the buddhas, the blessed ones, is like the form of an amalaka fruit in the palm of the hand.

"What is three? The three feelings come from the Śrāvaka Vehicle, not from the followers of the Great Vehicle. These are the three feelings: to hear it said that the Tathāgata, supreme in permanence, will become impermanent is a feeling; to hear it said that the true Dharma will decline is a feeling; to hear it said that the Saṅgha will disappear is a feeling. These three are the feelings of the Great Vehicle.

"What is four? 'The four noble truths' is a phrase well known in the Śrāvaka Vehicle; in the Great Vehicle there is nothing of that kind. The four truths are of this nature and function: 'The Tathāgata is permanent' is supremely true in the Great Vehicle, while suffering is not a truth. 'The Tathāgata is eternal' is supremely true, while the origin is not. 'The Tathāgata is supreme among the eternal' is supremely true, while cessation is not.

"'The Tathāgata is peace' is supremely true, while the path is not. In the Great Vehicle those are the four noble truths. The function of suffering is not a truth. If the function of suffering were a truth, the four kinds of suffering would become truths: those of the animals, the hungry ghosts, the asuras, and the inhabitants of the world of Yama would also become four noble truths.

"What is five? 'The five faculties' is a phrase well known in the Śrāvaka Vehicle, but not in the Great Vehicle. As for the five faculties: to meditate without any deficiency, 'I see clearly that the Tathāgata is permanent,' that is the eye. Having heard 'The Tathāgata is permanent,' to meditate without any deficiency, that is the ear. Having smelled the fragrance of the Tathāgata's permanence, to meditate without any deficiency, that is the nose. Having tasted the flavor of the tathāgatagarbha, to meditate without any deficiency, that is the tongue. Having heard and touched the supreme taste of that body,

'The Tathāgata is the Dharma body,' to meditate without any deficiency, that is the body.

"What is six? 'The six sense sources' is a phrase well known in the Śrāvaka Vehicle; in the Great Vehicle there are no six sense sources of this kind. What is called the six sense sources is this: to meditate fully by way of the entry of 'I see clearly that the Tathāgata is permanent,' that is the eye source. To meditate fully by way of the entry of hearing 'The Tathāgata is permanent,' that is the ear source. To meditate fully by way of the entry of smelling the fragrance of the permanent tathāgatagarbha, that is the nose source. To meditate fully by way of the entry of hearing the teaching of the tathāgatagarbha, that is the tongue source. To meditate fully by way of the entry of hearing and touching the sacred flavor of that body, 'The Tathāgata is the Dharma body,' that is the body source. The source that is the door of entry, being fully faithful, with an undisturbed mind, toward the clear teaching that the Tathāgata is manifest, that is the mind source.

"What is seven? 'The seven limbs of awakening' is a phrase well known in the Śrāvaka Vehicle. In the Great Vehicle too there are those seven, the seven limbs of awakening, a word as hard to find as the blossoming udumbara flower: through the Tathāgata's permanence they are seven flowers in full bloom.

"What is eight? 'The noble eightfold path' is a phrase well known in the Śrāvaka Vehicle. From this Great Vehicle too comes the noble eightfold path, right view and the rest. Moreover, fully to teach that 'the Tathāgata is supreme in permanence' is the noble eightfold path: merely by hearing of the greatness of the Tathāgata and fully touching it, one truly obtains the path that leads to nirvāṇa. The Tathāgata's permanence, eternality, the supreme immutability, become cool; the auspicious one is the Buddha; the Tathāgata is the Dharma body. 'The tathāgatagarbha is without aging': this should be understood to be the noble eightfold path.

"What is nine? 'The nine-limbed sūtras' is a phrase well known in the Śrāvaka Vehicle; in this Great Vehicle, unobstructed wisdom is called the single vehicle.

"What is ten? 'The ten powers of the Tathāgata' is a phrase well known from the Śrāvaka Vehicle; in this Great Vehicle they are not the ten powers of the Tathāgata but are called the infinite powers. Therefore the buddhas, the blessed ones, are inconceivable and unthinkable, and possess infinite powers. The buddhas, the blessed ones, teach infinite sūtras in intentional speech. This

is the single path. The Tathāgata is the single vehicle, the single refuge; he is followed for the sake of the single truth; he is of a single element, a single destiny, a single color; therefore it is called the single vehicle. The others are the work of skillful means."

Then the Blessed One gave Aṅgulimāla his approval: "Excellent, excellent! Excellent, Aṅgulimāla!" When the Tathāgata said to him, "Aṅgulimāla, monk Aṅgulimāla, come here! Monk Aṅgulimāla, come here!" Aṅgulimāla, like a monk of many years' standing, became in every respect beautiful in deportment, in keeping with a śramaṇa. Then Aṅgulimāla bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and the very instant the words "Blessed One, I shall go accordingly" came from his mouth, he attained there and then the supreme fruit, arhatship.

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, come! Liberating many tens of millions of beings, we shall go to the Jeta Grove like a king of geese."

Then the Tathāgata, together with Aṅgulimāla, with Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, the youthful Mañjuśrī, and others going before him and surrounding him, like the full moon in the sky surrounded by the planets, rose from the foot of the aśoka tree into the sky to the height of seven palm trees. From the place where the Tathāgata and Aṅgulimāla had contended as far as the Jeta Grove, across forty leagues, he went on, leaving not even a fathom's gap. Then Aṅgulimāla's mother, and the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, kinnaras, and mahoragas, made great offerings and came to the Jeta Grove.

Then the Blessed One, like a king of geese, went to the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the park of Anāthapiṇḍada, and the Tathāgata sat upon the lion throne. Then the great trichiliocosm world system became like the palm of the hand, and, soft to the touch like kācalindika cloth, it became like the world system Sukhāvatī.

Then the tathāgatas of each of the directions sent forth their bodhisattvas, saying, "Today the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, the great lion and tiger, having waged a great battle, is liberating many tens of millions of beings and teaching the Dharma, and you will see the great being Aṅgulimāla. Venerable ones, go today! Venerable ones, go today!" Sent forth in this way, they came to see Aṅgulimāla.

From each of the directions from which those bodhisattvas came, there fell a rain of scattered flowers the size of chariot wheels. Whatever beings touched the fragrance of the lotuses, all those beings became free of afflictions. Then

the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, mahoragas, and many goddesses made many divine offerings, brought forth a rain of various jewels, and with one voice spoke these words in verse:

"You bear the thirty-two marks and possess vast qualities;
Your face is beautiful like a supreme lotus in bloom.
Like the moon so beautiful in the sky,
Homage to you, with the beautiful curl between the brows!

Holy Sage, possessing the supreme form with its seven raised places,
Supreme in love, bearing many beneficial qualities,
Your face is beautiful like a supreme lotus in bloom.
Like the supreme moon in the sky,
Homage to you, with the beautiful curl between the brows!

Permanent, virtuous, matchless, possessing supreme and vast qualities,
Holy Sage, worshiped by the best of gods and humans,
Your face is beautiful like a supreme lotus in bloom.
Like the supreme moon in the sky,
Homage to you, with the beautiful curl between the brows!

Stable, virtuous, matchless, possessing supreme and vast qualities,
Holy Sage, worshiped by the best of gods and humans,
Your face is beautiful like a supreme lotus in bloom.
Like the supreme moon in the sky,
Homage to you, with the beautiful curl between the brows!

Eternal, supremely virtuous, possessing vast qualities,
Holy Sage, worshiped by the best of gods and humans,
Your face is beautiful like a supreme lotus in bloom.
Like the supreme moon in the sky,
Homage to you, with the beautiful curl between the brows!

Peaceful, virtuous, matchless, possessing supreme and vast qualities,
Holy Sage, worshiped by the best of gods and humans,
Your face is beautiful like a lotus in bloom.
Like the supreme moon in the sky,
Homage to you, with the beautiful curl between the brows!

Bearer of patience, bearer of moral discipline and infinite qualities,
Homage to you, Aṅgulimāla!
Holder of the single vehicle, teacher of the Great Vehicle,

Homage to the loving one, Aṅgulimāla!
Holder of infinite bodies, holder too of the infinite,
Holder of infinite speech, possessor of infinite intelligence,
Homage to you, Aṅgulimāla!
Holder of infinite light, teacher of infinite intentional speech,
Homage to you, Aṅgulimāla!
Holder of infinite illusions, tamer of infinite māras,
Who brings ten million afflictions to ripening,
Homage to you, Aṅgulimāla!
Showing infinite complete nirvāṇas,
Showing infinite births, conforming to the world,
Holder of supreme heroism, homage to you!"

Then Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, when you say, 'I abide in the limit of reality,' what does that mean? Blessed One, how is it that you abide and dwell in the limit of reality? You have declared, 'I abide on the ground of liberation.' Since one cannot simply place faith in that statement, please explain its reason here."

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, go today together with the youthful Mañjuśrī. North of here, beyond world systems as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, in the world system called Ungenerated Joy, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha named Source of the Qualities of Ungenerated Intelligence, King Lord of the Earth, is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata, 'Blessed One, in the Sahā world system, while the Tathāgata Śākyamuni is dwelling there, he says that he abides in the limit of the unborn. How is that?'"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla said, "Excellent, excellent!" and by the power of the bases of miraculous power they went like kings of geese to that world system Ungenerated Joy. They went to where the Blessed Tathāgata Source of the Qualities of Ungenerated Intelligence, King Lord of the Earth, was, approached him, bowed their heads at the Tathāgata's feet, and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, we two who have come here were sent from the Sahā world system by the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, and so we have come. Blessed One, how is it that the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, without having passed into complete nirvāṇa, and while dwelling right there, abides in the limit of the unborn, in liberation?"

That Blessed One said to the youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla, "Sons of good family, he who is the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, I myself am that Tathāgata, and that very Tathāgata will teach you. Sons of good family, go today, and say, 'That Blessed Tathāgata sent us back in this way.'"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla both rose, bowed their heads at that Blessed One's feet, said, "Very well," and came back like kings of geese. Bowing with palms joined toward where the Blessed One was, they said to the Blessed One, "Oh! The Tathāgata is immeasurable; the body of the Tathāgata is infinite. Oh! We have seen the very greatness of the Tathāgata. The Blessed Tathāgata Source of the Qualities of Ungenerated Intelligence, King Lord of the Earth, is that Tathāgata Śākyamuni. He said, 'That very Tathāgata will teach you,' and sent us back. Please teach how the Buddha, the Blessed One, while dwelling here, abides in the limit of the unborn."

The Blessed One said, "Do not say, 'How has he become the Tathāgata Source of the Qualities of Ungenerated Intelligence, King Lord of the Earth? How does he abide in the world system Ungenerated Joy? While staying here, how does he abide there? While staying here, how does he abide in the limit of the unborn?' The body of the Buddha is infinite; the Tathāgata moves infinitely. The Buddha, the Blessed One, is matchless; the Tathāgata moves matchlessly. The Buddha, the Blessed One, is immeasurable; the Tathāgata moves immeasurably.

"Aṅgulimāla, as for how the body of the Blessed One came to be unborn, ask the Tathāgata about the meaning of that, and the Buddha will teach it."

Then Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, out of compassion for all sentient beings, and for their benefit and happiness, please explain it well."

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, for a million eons I practiced the perfections and gathered sentient beings, establishing in awakening many tens of millions of sentient beings who had not generated the awakening mind. Through that root of virtue my body was brought to perfection over countless many tens of millions of eons, and through that root of virtue it became the unborn body."

Aṅgulimāla asked, "Blessed One, how did the Tathāgata come to have an unarisen body?"

The Blessed One said, "If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the

world system called Unarisen Lightning Garland, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Vairocana is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Aṅgulimāla, go today together with the youthful Mañjuśrī to the world system called Unarisen Lightning Garland, where the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Vairocana dwells, and ask how the Blessed One Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata, while dwelling in the Sahā world system, abides in the limit of reality."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla said, "Excellent!" and, like kings of geese, on the feet of the power of miraculous ability they went to that world system Unarisen Lightning Garland. They went to where the Blessed One Vairocana, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha was, and when they had arrived they put the same question to the Tathāgata. Having come here as before, Aṅgulimāla and the youthful Mañjuśrī said to the Tathāgata, "Blessed One, please explain how the Tathāgata abides in the unarisen limit."

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, for many hundreds of thousands of eons I gathered sentient beings through the ten perfections and established them in a bliss that had never arisen before. Thus over many tens of millions of eons, from immeasurable, countless perfections, my body became an unarisen body."

Aṅgulimāla asked, "Blessed One, how does he abide in the limit of the unconditioned?"

He said, "If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Captivating, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Akṣayamati is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself." The words "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" are likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, in the world system called Manifold, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Glory of Complete Victory is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called King

of the Profound, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Profundity is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Wind, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Source of the Life of Fragrance is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Vajra Intelligence, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Vajra is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Stainless Light, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Stainless Supreme is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Moonlit, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Moon is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

If one goes northward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Risen Sun, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Spread Parasol is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. "Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides" is likewise to be abbreviated as above.

The fifth fascicle.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Excellent Flavor, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Excellent Flavor is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Bandhujīvaka, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Light of the Bandhujīvaka is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Scented with Garlands, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Fragrance of Garlands is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Tamāla Leaf, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Fragrance of Tamāla Leaves is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with the Moon, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Candragarbha is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Aloeswood, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Fragrance of Aloeswood is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Scented with Powder, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Powdered Incense is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself.

Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Star, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Starlight is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Ocean Intelligence, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Sāgaradatta is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes eastward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Nāgas, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of the Nāgas is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Endowed with Marks, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Light of the Marks is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Great Cloud, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of the Great Cloud is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Garlanded with Lightning, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Giver of Lightning is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Vajra Intelligence, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Vajragarbha is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that

Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Beings, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Lord Who Upholds Beings is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Jewel Holder, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Holder and Bearer of Jewels is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Space, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Equal to Space is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Discipline, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Discipline is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Garland of Glory, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of Glory is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes southward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Lion Intelligence, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of the Lion is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Gentle, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called

Melodious is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Garland of the Ganges, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Gaṅgādatta is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Samantabhadra, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called All-Pervading Intelligence is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Flowers in Full Bloom, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Excellent Flower is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Infinite, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Infinite Flower is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Excellence, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of Excellence is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Lord of the Eye, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King of the Eye is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called

Endowed with Flowers, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of Kailāsa is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Sound of the Drum, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Voice of the Drum is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes westward from this buddhafield past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Beautiful to Behold, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Beauty is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River,

there, in the world system called Increasing Joy, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Increasing Joy is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Lovely, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Beautiful is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Causes, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of Causes is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Captivating Conduct, the Tathāgata,

the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Conduct is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Like Sentient Beings, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme among Sentient Beings is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Lightning, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Highest Lightning is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Delightful, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Delightful Voice is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Immeasurable, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Immeasurable is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Steadfast, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Steadfastness is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Taste of Water, the Tathāgata, the

arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Water is presently dwelling, living and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Crested, ask the Tathāgata Ratnaketu." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Jewel Light, ask the Tathāgata called Cool Jewel." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Jewels, ask the Tathāgata called Supreme Jewel." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Golden Light, ask the Tathāgata called Glorious Supreme Gold." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Golden Hue, ask the Tathāgata called Glorious Golden Light." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Golden, ask the Tathāgata called Supreme Gold of the Jambū River." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Netted, ask the Tathāgata called Light of the Net." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Stainless Water, ask the Tathāgata called King of Water." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Moral Discipline, ask the Tathāgata called Essence of Moral Discipline." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the northeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Jewel Island, ask the Tathāgata called Ratnasambhava how the Blessed One Śākyamuni abides." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Source of Vajras, ask the Tathāgata called Vajra Intelligence." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called All Buddhas, ask the Tathāgata called Crest of the Intelligence of All Buddhas." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Accomplished Intelligence, ask the Tathāgata called Glorious Siddhārtha." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Stainless Water, ask the Tathāgata called Stainless Beryl." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Delighting in the Nāga among Men, ask the Tathāgata Essence of the Nāga among Men." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Taste of Incense, ask the Tathāgata

called Heaped Incense." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Fragrant, ask the Tathāgata called Essence of Incense." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Light of Uprightness, ask the Tathāgata called Glory of Uprightness." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Priceless, ask the Tathāgata called Priceless." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southeast, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Infinite Crown, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha King of the Infinite." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Amitābha, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Amitābha." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Immeasurable Eye, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Immeasurable Lord." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Splendor of Fire, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Light of Fire." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges

rivers, there, in the world system called Dispeller of Darkness, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Possessed of Dispelling Darkness." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Gifts, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of Gifts." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Nonarising, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Lord of Nonarising." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Fragrant Elephant, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Subduer of Fragrant Elephants." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Vessel of Incense, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha King of the Vessel of Incense." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Melody of Joy, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Joy." This too is to be abbreviated as above.

"If one goes from this buddhafield toward the southwest, the intermediate direction, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Garland of Glory, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Supreme Glory of Victory is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Together with the Sight of the World, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Radiant Light of the King Supremely Exalted in Joy When All the World Beholds Him, Clad in the Great Armor of Emanated Arrays, Gateway of Illumination Shining upon All Kings Who Are Lords of the Earth, is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called White Lotus, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called White Lotus of the True Dharma is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Flowers Opened by Water, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Opener of Flowers is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Sorrowless, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Free of All Sorrow is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Blue Utpala, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Glory of the Jewel Utpala is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Possessing Lotuses, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Lotus Essence is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Endowed with Night Lilies, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete

Buddha called Night Lily Essence is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Saki Fragrance, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Saki Fragrance is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Kokaṅsika, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King of All Auspiciousness is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield upward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Possessing a Platform of Merit, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Lord of the Platform of Merit is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni is faring.

"If one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, there, in the world system called Lion's Way, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Lion's Play; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in two Ganges rivers,

there, in the world system called Tiger's Cave, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Tiger's Roar; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in three Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Sahakāra Tree, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called River of Sahakāra Flowers; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in four Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Victorious, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Tamer Victorious over All; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in five Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Source of Unattached Wisdom, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King Who Proclaims the Great Vehicle; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward,

past world systems as many as the grains of sand in six Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Source of Sky-Piercing, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Sky-Piercing Peak; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in seven Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Great Spectacle, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King of All Designs; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in eight Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Holding Intelligence, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King, Lord of Dhāraṇīs; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in nine Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called Intelligence of the Earth, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King of the Earth; and if one goes from this buddhafield downward, past world systems as many as the grains of sand in ten Ganges rivers, there, in the world system called King of Constant Joy, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called King, Source of Cutting Through All Doubt and Hesitation, is presently dwelling, living, and sustaining himself. Ask that Tathāgata how the Blessed One Śākyamuni dwells in the Sahā world system without passing into parinirvāṇa, and how he abides at the limit of liberation, adorned with the similes of the words of all the tathāgatas.

"Youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla, go now and ask that Blessed One, that Tathāgata. All your doubts and hesitations will be cut through. That is why that Tathāgata's name is Cutter of All Doubt and Hesitation."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "Excellent, excellent!" and bowed their heads at the Tathāgata's feet. By the power of the bases of miraculous power they went forth like a king of swans, and arrived in that world system called King of Constant Joy. They bowed their heads at the feet of the Tathāgata called Cutter of All Doubt and Hesitation, sat down to one side, and said:

"Blessed One, we two have come here from the Sahā world system, from the presence of the Tathāgata Śākyamuni. We also went into the presence of the ten buddhas of the ten directions, and asked all of them how the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, dwelling in the Sahā world system, abides at the limit of liberation while not passing into nirvāṇa. Those tathāgatas spoke thus: 'That Tathāgata Śākyamuni is one with us tathāgatas, so ask that Tathāgata.' And the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, also said, 'Sons of noble

family, you two ask the Tathāgata Cutter of All Doubt and Hesitation about me,' and sent us here, and so we have come. Blessed One, how does the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, dwelling in the Sahā world system without passing into nirvāṇa, abide at the limit of liberation?"

When they had asked this, that Tathāgata heard the words of the two and spoke thus: "Sons of noble family, return quickly! That Tathāgata will cut through all doubt and hesitation. That very Tathāgata is I; we are not different. Thus Śākyamuni is immeasurable." Having said this, he sent them back.

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said to the Blessed One, "Excellent, excellent!" and together with Aṅgulimāla bowed his head at that Tathāgata's feet. Then he went, came into the presence of the Blessed One, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, and said this:

"Ah! The body of the Tathāgata is held to be immeasurable and beyond counting. 'That very Tathāgata is I, and the Tathāgata Śākyamuni will cut through all your doubts. Go now!' With these words they too sent us back."

The Blessed One said, "Did that Tathāgata say, 'I myself am that Tathāgata'?"

They replied, "Just as that one said it, so all those tathāgatas said it. And finally, when we asked, all the tathāgatas said, 'I myself am that Tathāgata; we are one.'"

He said, "What are the world systems of those tathāgatas, those buddhas, those blessed ones like?"

The two replied, "In the world systems of all the tathāgatas, all those to which we went, there are no ravines or gullies at all. They are level like the palm of the hand, pleasant to the touch like kācalindika cloth, and, like the world system Sukhāvatī, free of the five degenerations. There are no śrāvakas, no pratyekabuddhas, and no women; there is the single supreme vehicle, and no one enters any other vehicle."

He said, "Whatever son or daughter of noble family properly recites the names of those tathāgatas, or asks about them, or even just listens to them, or keeps them in mind, or utters them, or proclaims them for the sake of others, or recites them oneself, will become free of all fears. None of the gods will harm such a person either. Likewise, such a person cannot be overcome by nāgas, yakṣas, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, gandharvas, and the rest. Having heard them, some will become protectors. By this the four destinies are cut off. Even those in whom the awakening mind has not arisen will obtain the

cause of awakening." So he said.

"Furthermore, Aṅgulimāla, the wonder of the Tathāgata's greatness is explained at length in the great sūtra Peerless Dhāraṇī, where eighty-one koṭis of buddhas say, 'I myself am that very Tathāgata.' Likewise, the praise of the buddhafields is inconceivable. Thus the Tathāgata too is immeasurable, and thus the form body of the Tathāgata too is limitless and countless. For one endowed with such defining qualities, how could impermanence or illness arise? Now I have taught you at length all the reasons, with their roots and with their causes and conditions, why the body of the Tathāgata is permanent and limitless.

"Because the people in this world system are nonvirtuous, all the buddhas do not wish to be king of this world system.

"Because I gave up my body again and again in order to establish the nonvirtuous in virtue, my body became an unborn body.

"Because, for many countless koṭis of eons, in order to protect the true Dharma, I let each of my bodies, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, be cut, hacked, and destroyed, and gave them away, my body became an indestructible, unconditioned, peerless body.

"For many koṭis of eons I persevered like a hero. In many places I gave up many bodies, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, and in each of those bodies I persevered like a hero for many koṭis of eons and practiced austerities; because of this, my body became an ageless body.

"For many countless koṭis of eons I was born in the intermediate eons of disease, and each of my bodies became supreme medicine; because I benefited beings as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, my body became a body free of illness.

"In many lifetimes, for many countless koṭis of eons, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, I pacified the disease of hunger of many koṭis of beings; because I gave them the elixir of the One Vehicle to drink, my body became a deathless body.

"For many countless koṭis of eons I removed the stains of many koṭis of afflictions from many koṭis of beings, and taught what is extremely difficult; because I taught the tathāgatagarbha, my body became a body free of afflictions.

"In lifetimes as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I completely pacified the suffering of thirst and hunger of many koṭis of beings who were pretas; because I satisfied them with the Dharma of the One Vehicle, my body, as many times as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, became an undefiled body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I cherished many koṭis of beings, gods and asuras included, as a mother, a sister, or a child; because of this, my body became a body free of harm.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who spoke untruth, in the truth of the Great Vehicle; because of this, my body became a body of permanent truth.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who did what is contrary to the Dharma, in the way of the transcendent Dharma; because of this, my body became the Dharma body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who had fallen under the sway of wrong views, in right view; because of this, my body became a body of supreme bliss.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who were terrified, in fearlessness; because of this, my body became a virtuous body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who were in great sorrow, in the Dharma of sorrowlessness; because of this, my body became a sorrowless body, free of sorrow.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many beings, gods and humans included, who lusted after the wives of others, in the armor of great moral discipline; because of this, my body became a body without dust and free of dust.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I gathered many koṭis of beings who were flawed and

disfigured, purified them thoroughly, and established them in the true Dharma; because of this, my body became flawless, a flawless Dharma body."

The sixth fascicle.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I gave the wealth and treasures of the Dharma to many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who had become poor; because of this, my body went from being without proper order to being a Dharma body of proper order.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who had fallen under the sway of desire, in freedom from affliction; because of this, my body became a Dharma body free of torment and without torment.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I shook off the afflictions of many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, and rendered the poison of vicious snakes harmless; because of this, my body became a Dharma body without contagion and free of contagion.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I became, through the Dharma of the perfections, a support for many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, who had no support in the world; because of this, my body became a body that illuminates the uncreated Dharma.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I spoke the utterly pure Dharma discourse on the tathāgatagarbha to many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included; because of this, my body became a body that is nothing whatsoever.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, in the clarity and wonder of the Tathāgata; because of this, my body became a wondrous body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I led many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, into union with buddhahood; because of this, my body became a supreme, sublime body, immeasurable and incalculable.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, in order to deliver many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, I displayed birth in this family and that, and because I fully delivered them, my body became a supreme, sublime body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I delivered many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, from all fears, and established them in awakening; because of this, my body became the unsurpassed Dharma body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I enabled many koṭis of beings with bodies lacking limbs to go about for the sake of the world, and established many beings in awakening; because of this, my body became the unsurpassed Dharma body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I did not conceal from the worlds the permanent element, the tathāgatagarbha, but taught it for the benefit of all beings; because of this, my body became a permanent body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, when I kept moral discipline, even though I saw daughters of the gods, daughters of Māra, and beautiful women of the world, I did not let my mind stray; because of this, my body became an indestructible body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I did not feel lust for the wives of the teachers of all the many koṭis of beings, nor for the wives of their elder brothers, nor for any women; because of this, my body became an indestructible Dharma body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I brought to an end the limitless faults of many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included; because of this, my body became a peerless, limitless body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I established many koṭis of beings who had gone into the animal realm in the profound Dharma; because of this, my body became a profound body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I taught the tathāgatagarbha as being like the track of

a bird in the sky, and made the buddha element clear; because of this, my body became a body that cannot be seen by looking.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I turned many koṭis of beings away from clinging to selflessness, and taught the tathāgatagarbha, which is hard to see; because of this, my body became a body hard for all beings to see.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I turned beings, gods and humans included, away from taking life, and established them in the true Dharma; because of this, my form became an exceedingly subtle body.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I brought forth the joy of the Dharma in many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included; because of this, my body became the body of a wise one.

"In many lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, for many countless koṭis of eons, I taught the tathāgatagarbha, the element, to many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, as Mañjuśrī does; because of this, my body became a body hard to see.

"For many countless eons I freed many koṭis of beings from all bonds and firmly established them in the state of liberation; from this my body became a body hard to see.

"For many countless eons I did not allow the many koṭis of beings among gods, humans, and hell beings to remain in any form of existence, but established them in liberation, in suchness; from this my body became a body with no basis anywhere at all.

"For many countless eons I did not think of the many koṭis of beings in terms of self and world, but regarded all beings as like the moon seized by Rāhu; from this my body became a body free of afflictions.

"For many countless eons I made many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, pure in the five bases of training; because of this, my body became a body whose bones, sinews, and limbs are pure.

"For many countless eons I made the vow, 'I will free all beings,' and, having made aspirations to do good, I delivered beings; therefore my body became a body liberated from everything.

"For many countless eons I drew out from many koṭis of beings the many kinds of painful thorns of the disease of bad views, and firmly established them in the Dharma of reality; from this my body became a peaceful, permanent body.

"For many countless eons, in many lifetimes, I unfailingly regarded all beings as my only son Rāhula, and likewise led others to do so; from this my body became a body of calm abiding.

"For many countless eons, having abandoned all conceptual thought, I held many koṭis of beings close. Even when I saw an enemy I kept company with him; I was content, kept my possessions few, and led others to this as well; therefore my body became a body of complete peace.

"For countless many lifetimes, having had many koṭis of beings give up material things, I taught them merely the contentment of the śrāvakas; from this my body became a body gone to the far shore, which has cut off every kind of wavering.

"For countless many lifetimes I gave up fish, meat, fat, and the foods that come from killing many koṭis of beings, and I had beings give them up likewise; from this my body became an excellent body.

"For countless many lifetimes I had many koṭis of beings, gods and humans included, purify all their many koṭis of afflictions; from this my body became a body free of conceptual elaboration.

"For countless many lifetimes, like a stroke of lightning, I destroyed the occasion for the many koṭis of beings who were flawed and disfigured, and brought it about that none were born so; from this my body became a body that has destroyed the ground of all.

"For many countless eons I gave the delicious elixir of the Dharma to drink to many koṭis of beings who wander because of the four inversions; from this my body became a divine body, like an emanated Brahmā.

"For many countless eons I set many koṭis of beings straight, saying, 'Do not mix faults into the secluded tathāgatagarbha, or into the search for the permanent'; from this my body became a secluded and liberated body.

"For many countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, I established many koṭis of beings in the words, 'This is the word of the Buddha,' as one points out the moon with the tip of a finger; from this my body became a body separated in every respect.

"For countless many lifetimes, although I brought to parinirvāṇa those to be brought to parinirvāṇa, and although I passed completely into parinirvāṇa, I did not bring about parinirvāṇa; therefore my body became, by the very nature of reality, the Dharma body.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I taught many koṭis of beings that the tathāgatagarbha, even when searched for with the greatest diligence, has no stain; from this my body became the body of the element.

"That element, moreover, is present in all beings. For many countless eons I taught the Great Vehicle, the wisdom without attachment, the gateway of selflessness, free of a self; as the fruit of that, my body became a body without sense sources.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I led many koṭis of beings to tame their many intense afflictions at all times; from this my body became a supreme body of virtue that transcends the world.

"For countless many lifetimes I became the support of all beings, the refuge of those without refuge, and the friend of those without friends; from this my body became a body like the river Sindhu flowing into the ocean.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, when I explained the sūtras, I gave rise to no fear or terror in teaching the tathāgatagarbha; from this my body became a steadfast body.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I gave up the reign of a universal monarch, in a palace white as a swan, high on its upper story, and many pleasures, and went into the forest; from this my body became a body like a dwelling place.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I always shunned the conduct of the lax, keeping far from it as from an outcaste; and when I stayed in one place with excellent ones endowed with moral discipline, I do not remember taking even a single cup of water. Therefore, from this I obtained a body without regret.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I lightened the burden of afflictions; from this my body became a thoroughly purified and radiant body.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, taking a prince as my example, I abandoned the faults of household life; from this my body became a body that does not seek.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I abandoned desire, aversion, and delusion, and exhausted the mass of afflictions; from this my body became a body without illness, without fear, and without pride.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, I denounced to many beings, gods and humans, the koṭis of afflictions that come from dallying with women as being like the venom of vicious snakes; from this my body became a body of cessation.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, having heard my own prophecy in the presence of the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara, while I was still like one of childish conduct, I strove diligently in suchness and explained the Great Vehicle to those who disparage the sūtras; from this my body became a body without location.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, having heard about the tathāgatagarbha, and because I was confident that over many koṭis of eons beings would destroy their afflictions and become buddhas, I undertook the conduct of becoming a refuge for all the koṭis of beings; as the fruit of that, my body became a body of refuge.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, when I was the bodhisattva, the sage Kṣāntivādin, I meditated on the four immeasurables; as the fruit of that, my body has become, even now, a body of refuge for all beings.

"Because I taught the Great Vehicle, the One Vehicle, the unsurpassed wisdom, the unattached wisdom, the great light, the wisdom that is an ally to all beings, even those who have committed countless evil deeds are purified once they hear the Great Vehicle. Therefore my body has become a body that is an ally.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I extolled the element, the element of bliss, the element of all beings, the stainless essence that cannot be harmed. As the fruit of that extolling, my body has become a body that cannot be harmed.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I established many koṭis of beings, gods and humans, in the state of liberation that has no abode. From that, my body has become a body that is unassailable and sovereign.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, I established many beings, men and women, in the attitude of regarding others as their fathers and mothers and as their sisters. Therefore my body has become, for all, a venerable body like a father.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in the Ganges, during the intermediate eon of great famine, I provided many kinds of sustenance, my own and that of others. From that, my body has become, everywhere, a body free of thirst, a divine body of serene appearance.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, throughout many lives I condemned the wish to kill the many koṭis of beings of every kind, and talk of killing them. From that, my body has become a body free of all the aggregates.

"Throughout many lifetimes I multiplied the causes of virtue in accordance with what the supreme physician taught: the body of excellent means, the Dharma body, the stable and infinite body. From that, my body has become a body in which formations are stilled.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I freed many koṭis of beings, exhausted my own afflictions, and showed the element that is my own nature as plainly as an āmalaka fruit. From that, my body has become a body that has cut off what is not Dharma.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I thoroughly disparaged the four elements to all the many koṭis of beings, saying that they are like the venom of a poisonous snake and are always empty, like an empty vessel. From that, my body has become a body born in keeping with the cause that was heard, a body without flesh or sinew.

"For countless lifetimes, as many as the grains of sand in many Ganges rivers, I brought all the many koṭis of beings in existence to pass completely beyond sorrow, to cessation and freedom from attachment, away from koṭis of afflictions. Because I brought them to complete nirvāṇa, from that my body has become a body of nirvāṇa, unmoving and blissful.

"Aṅgulimāla, for many koṭis of countless eons, while remaining right here, I dwell everywhere. Whatever is nirvāṇa is liberation, and whatever is liberation is the Tathāgata himself."

Then Aṅgulimāla said to the Blessed One, "Oh! The Buddha, the Blessed One, does what is difficult, out of loving compassion for all beings."

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, the Tathāgata does indeed do what is extremely difficult. In the future, at the time when the true Dharma will remain for only eighty years, to teach the Great Vehicle sūtra that teaches the tathāgatagarbha is to teach for the benefit of all beings and to do what is extremely difficult. Those beings who take its side are also said to do what is extremely difficult. And those beings who, having heard of the tathāgatagarbha, strive earnestly toward suchness also do what is extremely difficult."

Aṅgulimāla asked, "What is it like, this doing of what is extremely difficult?"

The Blessed One said, "It is like this. The great earth carries four great burdens. What are the four burdens? The burden of the great mass of water, the burden of the mountains, the burden of the grasses, shrubs, and trees on its surface, and the carrying of all beings as a burden. In this way the earth carries four great burdens."

Aṅgulimāla said, "That is heavy."

The Blessed One said, "The earth is not what carries a great burden. Why is that? Because there is another who carries a burden greater than the earth does."

He asked, "Blessed One, who is that holy person?"

He replied, "When the true Dharma will remain for only eighty years, the bodhisattva, the great being, who teaches for the benefit of all beings, when he teaches the tathāgatagarbha, will carry four burdens. What are the four? While corrupt and outrageous people roam about saying, 'We will kill him!', to disregard that danger, to give up even one's own life, and to teach the tathāgatagarbha: that is the first burden, heavier than a mass of mountains. To hear the angry and greedy words that these and many other corrupt and outrageous people speak against the one who teaches it, and to bear them with patience: that is the second burden, greater than the mass of water. To teach the tathāgatagarbha extensively to kings, ministers, generals, and lords who never get to hear the Dharma or to hear talk of the Dharma; to teach the

Dharma of mortality even to those lords, generals, and ministers who take its side but do not hear the Dharma; and to teach the Dharma to wicked beings of depraved mind, and to the deaf and the blind, who never get to hear it: that is the third burden, heavier than the burden of all beings.

"To live in the lands of barbarians, where it is hard to stay and hard to find a seat or bed, where the food is poor, the clothing poor, and the bedding poor, where there is famine and much strife, where beings quarrel and are afflicted; to bear patiently with these afflictions, and with the afflictions of people given over to objects of mere heedlessness with women, and the like; to be touched by every kind of suffering; and to teach the true Dharma in villages, in mountain hamlets, in valleys, in markets, in pleasure grounds, among the sugarcane, the great rice, the sāli rice, the wheat, the barley, the karasa and the byaraja, in places where no brahmins are found dwelling: that is the fourth great burden, a burden heavier than grass, shrubs, trees, and stone.

"The one who teaches these four great burdens is the bodhisattva who carries the great burden. When the true Dharma will remain for only eighty years, to give up even one's own life and teach the tathāgatagarbha is to do what is extremely difficult, and those beings who take its side also do what is extremely difficult. Those beings who, having heard of the tathāgatagarbha, have faith in it also do what is extremely difficult.

"Moreover, Aṅgulimāla, it is taught that the Tathāgata is not the one who does what is difficult; there is something still more difficult. For example, suppose a certain person were to have an immeasurable lifespan, and for immeasurable koṭis of years were to sit scooping out the water of the ocean with no more than the tip of a hair; and again, when immeasurable koṭis of years had passed, were to scoop out the ocean's water with the tip of a hair; and were to scoop out all such oceans in this way, until he had reduced them to no more than the water in a cow's hoofprint. Would that be doing what is difficult, or not?"

He said, "That is the very summit of doing what is extremely difficult. One cannot even call it merely difficult."

He said, "That is not doing what is difficult. Why is that? Because there is something else still more difficult."

"What is that?"

He said, "When the true Dharma will remain for only eighty years, the one who gives up even his own life and teaches the tathāgatagarbha is the bodhisattva, the great being, who does what is extremely difficult.

"Moreover, Aṅgulimāla, the Tathāgata is not the one who does what is difficult; there is yet another who does what is extremely difficult. For example, suppose a certain person were to carry Mount Meru, the king of mountains, together with the earth and the great ocean, on his shoulder, and remain so for koṭis of years. What would that person be like? Would he be strong, or not? How extremely difficult would that be?"

He said, "That is the domain of the Tathāgata; it is not the domain of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas."

He said, "That is neither strength nor doing what is difficult. Although one might be able to scoop out all the water of the ocean with a fraction of the tip of a minute particle over koṭis of years and many eons, until it was no more than the water in a cow's hoofprint, and though one might be able to carry the earth, Mount Meru, the rivers, and the oceans as a burden for many eons, in the future, when the true Dharma will remain for only eighty years, at a time when ordinary people will be unable to teach the true Dharma or to explain the tathāgatagarbha, the bodhisattvas, those elephants among men who teach for the benefit of all beings, will teach the tathāgatagarbha and uphold the true Dharma. That is declared to be doing what is extremely difficult.

"Moreover, Aṅgulimāla, could a blazing mass of fire filling a great trichiliocosm be put out with a handful of water?"

He said, "No, it could not. Why is that, Blessed One? Even the waters of the ocean could not put out that fire. If a handful of water cannot put out even a house that is ablaze, how could it put out a great trichiliocosm?"

He said, "Aṅgulimāla, in the same way, in the future, at a time when the side of those endowed with moral discipline dwindles and the side of those of bad character grows, when the true Dharma will remain for only eighty years, the bodhisattva, the great being, will give up even his own life, give away many kinds of lowly wealth such as male and female servants, cattle, and buffaloes, bring forth the true Dharma, and teach the tathāgatagarbha. What is that holy person like?"

He said, "The Blessed One himself knows; the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not understand it. At that time even the pure worldly dharma will be hard to

explain, so what need is there to speak of teaching the pure dharma that transcends the world, the tathāgatagarbha? Thus that holy person goes there in order to put out, with a handful of water, the blazing mass of fire of a great trichiliocosm. I think that the one who does this extremely difficult thing is no other person than the Tathāgata himself."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent, son of good family! I too have spoken those very words. Even if all the buddhas were to describe the qualities of that person who does what is extremely difficult for as many as koṭis of eons, they would not find their end.

"Moreover, son of good family, it is like this: just as the inflow of all the rivers into the great ocean's mass of water cannot be seen, so too, within that person's mind, the minds of the whole world are not seen to enter.

"Moreover, son of good family, just as the great ocean casts out the corpses of all beings, so too that holy person does not even glance from the corner of his eye, has no attachment to a household, does not mix with those who are not in accord with the Dharma, and also shuns those who disparage the tathāgatagarbha. Such a holy person does what is extremely difficult. And those who take his side and listen to him are also my śrāvakas who do what is extremely difficult.

He asked, "Blessed One, with how many characteristics is one a new bodhisattva, a great being?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, one who possesses eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva, a great being. What are the eight? Reflecting on the Dharma; examining and analyzing it; taking it up and retaining it; showing great respect to father and mother; repaying the kindness of one's own teacher; being at odds with all views; disregarding all signs and being skilled in the Vinaya; giving up everything improper; and a mind free of desire, so that one does not emit semen even in dreams, and is respectful toward moral discipline. One who possesses these characteristics is a new bodhisattva.

"Again, one who possesses eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva. What are the eight? Teaching the Great Vehicle; teaching the tathāgatagarbha clearly and being endowed with generosity; not craving material things; being endowed with loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity; regarding all beings as one would an only child; relying on spiritual friends; completely giving up evil companions; and being content with gain and honor. One who

possesses these eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva.

"Again, one who possesses eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva. What are the eight? Being helpful; being fitting in conduct; speaking gently and gladly; having few afflictions; being endowed with patience; having the patience to listen to all the sūtras through to the end; overcoming sleep; rising without sloth and being heedful; and delighting in the training. One who possesses these eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva.

"Again, one who possesses eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva. What are the eight? Being truthful and pure; keeping clean; being learned; being radiant and of fine form; avoiding the company of women; keeping far from the homes of relatives; being wary of all evil ascetics because of their various harms; having the hair of one's body stand on end as soon as one hears [the Dharma]; and being loving and kind toward all living creatures. One who possesses these eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva.

"Again, one who possesses eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva. What are the eight? Knowing the difference between what is spoken by Māra and what is declared by the Buddha; honoring knowledge of the sūtras; knowing the difference between what is Vinaya and what is not Vinaya, and not concealing it; being skilled in what the Tathāgata spoke with a hidden intention; knowing what the Tathāgata has said; knowing in what one should conform to the world; knowing the Tathāgata to be permanent; being skilled in what is evil, what is not evil, and the activities of a bodhisattva; and fully knowing place, time, wisdom, and one's own capacity. One who possesses these eight characteristics is a new bodhisattva.

"Whoever possesses these forty characteristics and possesses the dharma of mindfulness of the body is called a new bodhisattva. One who does not have the forty qualities but has half of them, or half of half, should be known as a son or daughter of good family who has rightly entered the Great Vehicle, but is not counted among the bodhisattvas. Therefore the conduct of a bodhisattva is doing what is extremely difficult. Which of these is the supreme quality? To have no thought of lust, so that one does not emit semen even in dreams: such a person should be known as one who has the cause, and this is the supreme quality among all the factors of awakening."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said to Aṅgulimāla, "What is the meaning of what is spoken of as 'the tathāgatagarbha, the tathāgatagarbha'? If all beings have the tathāgatagarbha, then all beings will become buddhas. Is it then

permissible for all beings to kill, to lie, to drink liquor, to engage in sex, to take what is not given, and to follow all the paths of nonvirtuous action? If the buddha-element is present in all beings, when will they be freed and go forth? If the buddha-element is present, then everyone will also commit the deeds of immediate retribution and acts of great desire. If all beings have the element of a self, they will free themselves. But since there is no element of a self in the maturation of karma, there is therefore no element in the world or in a self. That everything is without self: that is the teaching of the Buddha."

The Blessed One said, "All beings have the tathāgatagarbha, but it lies covered by koṭis of afflictions, like a lamp inside a vase.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, the Blessed One Kāśyapa, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, prophesied of a washerman's only son: 'Seven years from today he will become a wheel-turning king, a Dharma king who keeps to the Dharma. And I will pass into complete nirvāṇa in seven days.' When this was prophesied, the washerman's son was overjoyed. He thought, 'The Omniscient One has prophesied that I will be a wheel-turning king; it will happen without doubt,' and in his great delight he said to his mother, 'Mother, give me fish, meat, milk, sesame sweets, curd, buttermilk, broth, and ground grain! I shall become very strong!' He mixed them all together and ate them, and died, simply an untimely death. He died by his own doing; he brought about his own ruin. Did the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, then speak falsely? Or was he not omniscient? Or did that man not have the root of virtue for becoming a wheel-turning king, and the ripening of merit?"

He said, "He died because he had done bad deeds before."

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, do not say that. What befell him was merely an untimely death; it was not that he had done bad deeds before. When the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, made his prophecy, would he have prophesied without knowing the deeds that man had done before? He did not die because of bad deeds done before. He was at fault himself; he killed himself.

"Mañjuśrī, in the same way, whether it is a man or a woman, if someone thinks, 'Since I have the tathāgatagarbha, it will free me by itself, so I will do evil,' and does evil, will that element of theirs free them? It is as was explained before: like the washerman's son, although they have the element, it does not free them. Why is that? Because those who are given to much heedlessness are heedless, the dharmadhātu does not free them.

"Do beings, then, not have the buddha-element? The buddha-element is present in all beings, just as the ripening that would have brought kingship was present in him. Does the Buddha speak falsely? The Buddha does not speak falsely. Beings who speak falsely are drunk with heedlessness, and even having heard the teaching, they will not attain buddhahood, because of their own fault."

He asked, "Should it be said, then, that no beings have karma done in the past?"

He said, "The sūtras do say that there is such karma. Yet merely by hearing this, the deeds done over countless upon countless eons will be exhausted. Why is that? Because many countless koṭis of eons ago the Tathāgata made a vow for the sake of the world: 'Having freed myself, I will free all beings. Having crossed over myself, I will carry all beings across.' Through the root of virtue of that vow, by the Tathāgata's splendor, like the light of the sun, the deeds that have been done will be exhausted without remainder.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, for example, clouds, mist, the haze of frost, and other blemishes obscure the world for as long as the sun has not risen; but as soon as the sun rises, they vanish in the time of a snap of the fingers. In the same way, for as long as the sun of this sūtra has not risen, all beings wander through koṭis of rounds of saṃsāra, with countless heaps of evil done; but as soon as the sun of this sūtra rises, even the countless heaps of evil they have done vanish in the time of a snap of the fingers.

"Those who have mocked the tathāgatagarbha, or despised it, or sneered at it, or followed others, or gone outside this teaching, or incurred a defeat, or committed a deed of immediate retribution: even the countless evils they have done will be exhausted in a single instant. Why is that? Because whoever merely hears the name of the Tathāgata Śākyamuni becomes a bodhisattva, even without having generated the resolve. Therefore, through the special character of that Tathāgata's aspiration, for his own sake and for the sake of the world, having freed himself he frees others. He awakens, with koṭis of teachings of the true Dharma, the beings who lie asleep through koṭis of rounds of saṃsāra. Mañjuśrī, that is why one who hears the name of the Tathāgata becomes a bodhisattva. One should hasten to cut through the koṭis of afflictions oneself. Through that, one will come to hold my body.

"Mañjuśrī, I have said, 'I have taught the path that cuts out the dart of sorrow. The Tathāgata is one who shows the way; now you must strive.' So I taught the

path. The path that was taught is of two kinds. What are the two? The path of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the path of the bodhisattva. The path of the Śrāvaka Vehicle is the noble eightfold path. The path of the bodhisattva is this: 'All beings have the tathāgatagarbha. Just as I attained the unmoving state in my own element, so, in the way the Sugata intended, one should cut through the koṭis of afflictions. If they are not cut, one will certainly go rolling around in the wheel of saṃsāra.' Thus I taught the path that cuts out the dart of sorrow.

"'Sorrow' means affliction. 'Drawing out the dart' is a figurative expression of the Tathāgata. The meaning is this: 'I destroy the koṭis of afflictions, doing the work of emetics, purgatives, and lancing, like a physician. You too, by your own nature, attend upon me, and I will explain the tathāgatagarbha.' 'Now you must strive' is something spoken with a hidden intention. 'The Tathāgata is one who shows the way' also means this: 'Cut off this birth! Cut it off! The appearance of a buddha is like the udumbara flower. Perfect faith is like a nugget of gold. To please the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, is like the blind turtle putting its head through the hole in a yoke. Do not let this sūtra of the tathāgatagarbha go to waste! Make your life and your livelihood bear fruit! Free yourself from all existence and from all the diseases of affliction!' Therefore the Tathāgata is the Teacher.

"'Even if one is slack in merit, the mind takes no delight in evil': I taught this in the Śrāvaka Vehicle. The tathāgatagarbha is extremely hard to find. It is without equal in the world, and so it is extremely hard to find. Because it is without equal in the world, look quickly to the tathāgatagarbha: that is the meaning of 'act in this way'.

"What is the meaning of the saying 'the mind takes no delight in evil'? I shall explain its meaning. The mind is completely pure by nature. Through the fault of relying on unwholesome friends, monks are led and surrounded by many stains, the five stains and the rest. What are the five stains and the rest? Desire and craving; much ill will; torpor and sleep, these three; agitation; and doubt. These five spoil the mind. One should strive to purify the many stains, the five stains and the rest. One should strive for the sake of the mind that is pure by nature.

"'Hasten, hasten' means: for as long as you have not come to reject the sūtras, and for as long as you have not become greedy, strive to free yourself. The meaning of these words is this: to dig out by the root the koṭis of afflictions, the adventitious stains, in keeping with the mind as it is; that is the meaning of

the words 'hasten, hasten'.

"Mind goes before all things;
mind is chief, and they are of the nature of mind.
Those who act and those who speak
with a mind made clear and bright
will come to be endowed with happiness;
it follows them like a shadow.

"What is taught as 'mind' in the Śrāvaka Vehicle also means the tathāgatagarbha. What is called 'the mind that is pure by nature' is the tathāgatagarbha.

"It is the chief of all things; all things have the nature of the tathāgatagarbha. Again, 'acting with a mind made clear' means this: having cut through all the koṭis of afflictions and revealed one's own element, what is made clear is the tathāgatagarbha itself. Then 'speaking and acting' afterward means this: having attained buddhahood, whatever one says and whatever one does all serves to free the world completely. At that time, just as a person sees his shadow, one sees the tathāgatagarbha. That is why it is said, 'it follows like a shadow.' This is the meaning of that verse.

"Mind goes before all things;
mind is chief, and they are of the nature of mind.
What is spoken and what is done
with a mind deeply troubled
will come to be endowed with suffering,
as with a cart that is drawn along.

"The meaning of that verse concerns the koṭis of afflictions. 'The mind is deeply troubled' means that it is troubled because it is covered by koṭis of afflictions. 'Whatever the mind has become' means that the tathāgatagarbha has entered into the koṭis of afflictions. From then on, all speaking and acting leads toward suffering. 'As with a cart that is drawn along' means this: just as the wheel follows the ox, so, through heaps of evil, beings wander about on the spinning wheel of saṃsāra, in the hells and in the birthplaces of animals. Therefore the saying 'even if one is slack in merit, the mind takes no delight in evil' is established.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, because people know that there is butter in cow's milk, they churn it. Why do people not churn water? Because the substance is not there. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, it is because the tathāgatagarbha exists that

people guard moral discipline and lead the holy life.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, a discerning person who wants gold digs into rock. Why does he not dig into wood? He digs into stone, which contains the element of gold; he does not dig into wood, which has no gold. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, discerning people, seeing that the element is present, think, 'I will become a buddha,' and guard moral discipline and lead the holy life.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, if there were no element, the holy life would be meaningless. Just as no butter comes forth even if one churns water for koṭis of years, so, if there were no element of the self, the holy life and the practice of moral discipline undertaken out of attachment to the self would be meaningless."

Mañjuśrī asked, "What is the meaning of what is called 'the holy life, the holy life'? Why did the Tathāgata give up indulgence in the pleasures of the senses?"

Aṅgulimāla also said, "Knowing that through it many gods and humans certainly fall, he gave up the perception of desire."

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, do not say that. Because all beings have the tathāgatagarbha, all beings are brothers in the Dharma, and all women are sisters."

Aṅgulimāla said, "If King Śuddhodana and Queen Māyā were also brother and sister, how did they become father and mother?"

The Blessed One said, "That was shown through magical activity, in order to free the world of others. It is like this: two royal wrestlers set up a stake of a thousand, and by prior agreement they strike each other, and without truly grappling put on a show of winning the stake of a thousand. They delight the king and all his court, but the people do not know what is really going on. In the same way, the buddhas, the blessed ones, employ skillful means and display a father and a mother, and themselves as steadfast men; then afterward they free many beings from the inexhaustible ocean of existence, and beings do not know what is really going on.

"It is like this: in a gathering for a musical performance, a male dancer dances, and in the dance and the episodes of the story he becomes a man, a woman, and a neuter, and quickly delights many beings. In the same way, the Buddha, the Blessed One, displays his own body like a great dancer, and frees many koṭis of beings, and beings do not recognize it as that person's skillful means.

"It is like this: in the midst of a gathering for a musical performance, a magician cuts himself up in many ways and plays, delighting many beings, yet there is no injury and no wound. In the same way, like a magician, in order to benefit many beings he displays himself as an illusory emanation.

"Again, Mañjuśrī, the Tathāgata possesses all the wisdom of omniscience. When he looks carefully at the whole world, he sees that in transmigrating and wandering through saṃsāra from beginningless time, there is no one who has not been one's mother and no one who has not been one's sister. A mother has become a wife, a servant has become a father, and a father has become a servant. Since the world, living through many koṭis of lifetimes, is like a dancer, the Tathāgata led the holy life.

The seventh fascicle, the last.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, whoever plays the game of lust together with his own element, taking some small pleasure for himself, will fare as has been said: if he himself is born as a neuter, that pleasure gives rise to a mass of suffering. Women too have the tathāgatagarbha, and so do men. How then could it be fitting to seize them for oneself and do as one likes? Therefore the element of all beings is a single element. Having undertaken the holy life, the Tathāgata went to where no self is set up."

Mañjuśrī asked, "Why did the Tathāgata not establish all laymen and laywomen in the holy life? Why is it that, when laymen, laywomen, monks, and nuns are given as the example of a house with four pillars, as the cause of the true Dharma, great evil still arises? Why have laymen and laywomen come to have such evil? And why were Vinaya rules laid down for laymen and laywomen?"

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, that is a different perception; it is designated with the name of a worldly perception.

Although the Tathāgata establishes all sentient beings in the state of a buddha, this is not to be grasped in the manner of Rāhula. The question in which the perception of a buddha and the perception of the world differ is called a question one does not ask. Mañjuśrī, since it is the element of all sentient beings, to give up the taking of life is the Buddha. Son of good family, just as with killing oneself, so it is with taking life in the world: it is the destruction of one's own element."

Mañjuśrī asked, "Blessed One, why is it that you regard beings equally, as you regard Rāhula, and yet teach that the faulty, depraved ones who hold their own element are to be punished with penalties and killed?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, do not say that. The Tathāgata regards them equally with Rāhula. It is like this, Mañjuśrī: suppose a man who longs for the Dharma eats twice a day, and someone instructs him so that he comes to eat only once. Eighty kinds of worms will be killed. If that were so, they would not be pure of taking life.

"Furthermore, Mañjuśrī, for a noble one who has turned away from the pleasure of those who long for great comfort, to destroy desire is to kill the self. If the noble ones were like that, they would incur the evil of killing the self. If a thought of desire arises in someone while he is staying in the presence of another, do not say, 'If a thought of desire has arisen in me, what am I to do?' From that, shame will arise. Whether this body of mine exists or does not exist, when one remains like a hero and so kills the self, does that become the destruction of one's own element?"

"It does not, Blessed One. That is a heap of merit."

"In the same way, Mañjuśrī, the noble one kills the self in this way. And why is that? It is because of the poison of the afflictions; it does not amount to killing another. The words of the Buddha's Dharma cause the faulty, depraved ones who destroy the true Dharma to cease to exist, just as with my inexhaustible afflictions, and they also make them suffer harm that is improper; those are offerings to me. Just as one gives up what one holds dear, one's pleasures, one's food, and one's very life, so to punish the faulty, depraved ones out of a wish to give up the self is to know the buddha-nature."

Mañjuśrī asked, "Is it because of the buddha-nature that the buddhas do not eat meat?"

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, that is exactly so. In all those lifetimes of circling in saṃsāra, which has neither beginning nor end, there is no sentient being who has not been one's mother or one's sister. One who has been a dog has also become one's father; the world of the living is like a dancer. Therefore, since one's own flesh and the flesh of others are one flesh, the buddhas do not eat meat. Furthermore, Mañjuśrī, the element of all sentient beings is the element of reality (dharmadhātu). Since one would be eating the flesh of what has become a single element, the buddhas do not eat meat."

Mañjuśrī asked, "Are not honey, conch shell, leather shoes, silk from silkworms, and the like the flesh of one's own element?"

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, do not say that. The Buddha has given up all worldly bodies. Since the Buddha is free of material things, it is impossible for him to rely on any object of attachment whatever. Resorting to material things is the nature of skillful means. One makes use of a thing that has come from one person to another; one should not make use of it there, at the place from which the thing originates. What has come from one person to another, and not from the hand of a killer, may be made use of."

Mañjuśrī asked, "Suppose that in a marketplace a shoemaker sews shoes out of leather and offers them to the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha. Would he accept them, as something that has come from one person to another?"

Mañjuśrī asked, "Suppose a buffalo dies by its own nature, the leather is taken from the buffalo's owner, a caṇḍāla, a shoemaker is sought out and it is sewn into shoes, and these are given to someone who keeps moral discipline. Has that come from one person to another?"

The Blessed One said, "If the buffalo died by its own nature, and the buffalo's owner had shoes sewn and gave them to someone who keeps moral discipline, should he accept them? Or if he did not accept them, would that be in keeping with a monk? It would be without compassion, and it is not that his moral discipline would remain untorn."

Mañjuśrī said, "Plowing and digging are not allowed either, and food cooked with impure water is not to be accepted either. That being so, this is how it is for monks."

The Blessed One said, "That is called a worldly perception. If there are laymen, let pure food and drinking water be provided. Where there are laymen, one should not plow or dig. But where there are no laymen, what is even a buddha to do? There are living creatures on the ground, there are living creatures in the water, and there are living creatures in the sky. If that is so, would it not be evil for those who have achieved purity? How would those who have achieved purity go about? That is the question called the question not asked in the world."

Mañjuśrī said, "Blessed One, for a long time now even worldly people have not engaged in eating meat, which is eating oneself."

The Blessed One said, "Whatever among worldly people accords with the word of the Buddha should, in every respect and in its entirety, be recognized as the word of the Buddha. Mañjuśrī, worldly people also speak of liberation, but there is no liberation among them; in the teaching of the Blessed One there is liberation. They too have going forth, but theirs is not going forth; in the teaching of the Blessed One there is going forth. Among worldly people too it is said that eating meat is eating oneself, yet even so it is not eating their own flesh; in the teaching of the Blessed One it is certain that it is eating one's own flesh. Mañjuśrī, do you wish to hear what this sūtra teaches of how all the depraved ones arose in the world?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I do."

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, in a time long past, more countless than countless eons, vaster than vast eons, more immeasurable than the immeasurable, at that time, in that age, a tathāgata called Excellent Kosanta appeared in the world, in this very city. At that time there were no depraved ones, and even the name 'depraved one' did not exist.

Sentient beings had become followers of the Great Vehicle, and sentient beings were endowed with great happiness. Then that Tathāgata, having remained in this world system for many years, passed into complete nirvāṇa. His teaching too remained for many years after his complete nirvāṇa. Then, when the true Dharma was in decline, at a time when monks who kept moral discipline were dwindling and the side of what is not Dharma was growing, a monk called Buddhamati was living in a hermitage. A certain sentient being who possessed roots of virtue gave that monk a priceless robe, and the monk accepted it in order to take him into his care. As he went off, displaying it, past the enclosure of Ishinda, a man of Ishinda saw the robe and his mind was perverted. In the darkness of night he went to where the monk was, stole the robe, led him off into the mountains, stripped him naked, bound him tightly to a tree with his arms raised up, and went away.

That same night, in the darkness, a brahmin who gathered flowers came carrying his basket to the wild uplands. When dawn broke, he was terrified because a tiger was lying at the foot of a campaka tree. Just about to be killed by the tiger, he fled wherever he could, and as he went on and on, utterly miserable, he saw the śramaṇa bound there naked. He thought, "Alas! This forest-dwelling śramaṇa in saffron robes has come to this. See, the banner of saffron does not bring liberation!" Thinking, "I shall raise my arms, go about

with my body naked, and practice austerities," and wondering, "Is this path not well accomplished as the path that surely leads to liberation?", in order to destroy the true Dharma he threw away his own poor clothes, plucked out his hair, and became a shaven-headed naked śramaṇa. From that the naked śramaṇas arose.

That monk freed himself from his bonds, took some tree bark, and smeared it with yellow earth. A brahmin walking on the plain saw him, saw him just as was described before, and thought, "This is a monk who wore saffron. If one throws away the saffron and goes about smeared with ochre, this is the path of liberation." Wondering, "Does this lead to virtue, or what?", he became a wanderer. From that the wandering ascetics (parivrājakas) arose.

The monk, now covered in dust, came on this way. He washed the wound on his head with water and covered the head wound with soft hair, and he put on a cloth that a cowherd had thrown away after killing a snake with it. While he was bathing, another man, a wood-gatherer, saw him, and seeing, as before, that monk in his afflicted state, he thought, "This śramaṇa wore saffron, and the banner of saffron does not bring liberation." He grew long matted locks, put on a garment of grass, and took up the practice of the austerity of bathing three times a day. Wondering, "Is that virtue?", and declaring, "This alone is the path of liberation, and no other," he became an ascetic. From then on, the depraved ones who practice austerities arose.

That monk came on this way, with all his many wounds oozing pus, his body covered with dust and flies swarming about him. When that monk was seen covered with soft hair, the conduct of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and the Pāśupatas arose in that way.

That monk blew on a fire of dried cow dung to warm himself, and another afflicted man saw him. From that, at the very beginning, arose those who carry balls of cow dung.

That monk, feeling the pain touching his wounds, sat in the posture of a hero. Another afflicted man saw him, as before, and thought, "Wearing saffron does not bring liberation." Wondering, "What would be the right way to go?", he thought, "To go to the unmoving ground is liberation," and so he took to going to the unmoving ground, which is sorrow.

In this way, those who became depraved ones, up to ninety-six of them, each came there from their own direction, and seeing that monk in whatever state he was in, they conceived of him in one way or another through wrong views.

It is like this: just as people who see one another as deer and think, "I shall kill the deer," kill one another, so in the same way the ninety-six depraved ones arose. And just as in the first month of summer the deer think a mirage is water and go toward it, so at the time when the true Dharma is in decline they turned away from the foundation of a monk.

Mañjuśrī, in this way all the moral disciplines, conduct, and supreme practices of the world are emanations of the Buddha. At the time when the true Dharma is in decline, if such things arise, the Dharma will decline.

Mañjuśrī, in the same way, just like the wrong view that says, "My reality is like this, it is like that," namely, not understanding the intentional speech about liberation, the self, and what transcends the world, they imagine, "Selflessness is the word of the Buddha," just as the non-Buddhists arose. Even worldly people who are established by inference have come under the power of the doctrine of delusion. And not understanding what is taught in intentional speech about what transcends the world, their understanding is ruined. Therefore, the two extremes having been avoided, the reality of the phenomena that belong to the self, and the suchness of the Tathāgata and of the Saṅgha, are taught as the Tathāgata's vehicle, the path of the Middle Way. "The path of the Middle Way" is a synonym for the Great Vehicle."

Aṅgulimāla said, "Because they do not understand the path of the Middle Way, sentient beings conceive of the path of the Middle Way as something else."

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla, having heard this sūtra taught, many sentient beings will come to have faith in this sūtra. In the future, many sentient beings will revile this sūtra."

Aṅgulimāla asked, "Blessed One, please explain in which regions, and how many, those who revile the sūtras will appear, and how many of those of great desire (icchantikas) will appear. And may the Tathāgata please explain in which regions those who teach what will benefit all sentient beings will appear."

The Blessed One said, "In the future, here in the central land, ninety-eight hundred thousand koṭis of sentient beings who revile the sūtras will appear, and seven koṭis of icchantikas will appear. In the east, ninety-eight thousand who revile the sūtras will appear, and seven koṭis of icchantikas will appear. In the south, ninety-eight thousand who revile the sūtras will appear, and sixty koṭis of icchantikas will appear. In the west, ninety-nine koṭis who revile the sūtras will appear, and fifty koṭis of icchantikas will appear. In the north,

ninety-eight koṭis who revile the sūtras will appear, and forty koṭis of icchantikas will appear.

"In the land of Kashmir too, my teaching, the treasury and treasure of the remaining volumes, will not be lost. In Bharukaccha too there will be a treasury of my remaining volumes, and likewise on Mount Vindhya. The monks of the land of Kashmir, not understanding the meaning of practice, will come to revile the whole of the Great Vehicle, and I too feel shame, wondering, 'What is to be done about this slander of me?'

"In the southern region the Great Vehicle will be taught. Those who make diligence their essence, who practice the conduct of the Tathāgata and are free of the eight great things, will teach that the Tathāgata is permanent, eternal, and at peace, and that the buddha-nature is stable. My śrāvakas, the monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen, will make diligence their essence, and they will take up my teaching as their burden."

Mañjuśrī said, "Oh, Blessed One! Will the teaching of the Blessed One remain in the south?"

The Blessed One said, "So it is, Mañjuśrī. In the southern region my teaching will remain for many years. Bodhisattvas like you, who do what is extremely difficult, will give up their own lives and, for the benefit of all sentient beings, will teach the buddha-nature, saying, 'The Tathāgata is permanent, the Tathāgata is eternal, the Tathāgata is everlasting.'

"For example, all the tathāgatas in this world system did not want great kingship but took up a great burden, saying, 'I shall deliver the great trichiliocosms,' and delivered them for many koṭis of eons. In the same way, at the time when my true Dharma is in decline after many koṭis of eons, when the true Dharma will remain for eighty years, all my śrāvakas will not want to carry the burden of the true Dharma. But, Mañjuśrī, those like you, when the true Dharma will remain for eighty years, will carry the great burden of the true Dharma. Thinking, 'I have taken the true Dharma upon my shoulders,' they will teach thoroughly to the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa and of all the lesser continents, even at the cost of their own lives, that the buddha-nature is permanent, eternal, at peace, and everlasting, thinking, 'Whether sentient beings believe it or not, whether my body is killed or cut into pieces, only then will my body become a permanent body.' Such bodhisattvas, who carry this burden and do what is extremely difficult, will arise from the southern region.

"There are śrāvakas of mine like these, and many koṭis of sentient beings such as you; that is why the southern region is highly praised. My final Dharma will be taught there. Through the power and splendor of those bodhisattvas, all the people of Jambudvīpa without exception will apply themselves diligently, out of scruple, out of fear, and out of pride. It is like this: just as kings who hear of the laws made by another king themselves care for their subjects in the same way, so the assembly of the land of Kashmir and the people of the land of Bharukaccha will also, out of shame and pride, come to teach it, but they will teach it in secret, being afraid and terrified of the Great Vehicle; they will not teach the buddha-nature.

"Mañjuśrī, it is like this: if fire is put into a heap of chaff, the middle of the heap is burned and a remnant is left, while the edges do not burn. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, the land where I was first born is one of zealous diligence, yet of what is burned a remnant is left in the southern region; in that land on the periphery bodhisattvas will be born and will bring forth the true Dharma, and there the perfect Buddha is renowned as appearing."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, together with many attendants from the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, bowed his head at the feet of the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, made great divine offerings, and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I shall protect this sūtra and pass it on. Out of love for all sentient beings, may the Tathāgata please state the name of this sūtra."

The Blessed One said, "Kauśika, hold the name of this sūtra to be Benefiting Aṅgulimāla. Kauśika, this sūtra is extremely hard to find in the world, like the udumbara flower."

Then the eldest son of Indra, called Openly Wrathful, who was handsome, joyful, and delightful, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and said this: "Blessed One, when my father was fighting the asuras, he said to his charioteer, called Thought-Holder, 'Drive the chariot so that the gods prevail and the asuras are defeated!' And the charioteer replied, 'My lord, do not think otherwise. I shall perish first, and you only after me.'

Whether we succeed or not, I give up my own life, I abandon even friendship with others, and I put on the great armor.' In the same way, Blessed One, at the time when I too am no longer here, when the true Dharma will remain for eighty years, at that time I too will act. When that bodhisattva who teaches the buddha-nature as the permanence, the eternity, and the everlastingness of the Tathāgata afterward comes to think, 'There are not many sentient beings

left to whom the teaching of the buddha-nature should be taught, so now I will not teach it,' then, having heard of the means that was employed in that story, I too, like the man called Thought-Holder, will yoke the chariot of the Dharma. By every means, so that the buddha-nature may spread widely in the world as permanence, eternity, everlastingness, and peace, I will give up even my life. May I teach it in the guise of a monk, and may I be made pure throughout all eons!"

Then many sons of Indra, and women, and girls, and other gods bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One and said, "Blessed One, we too will give up our lives and, in the guise of monks, in the guise of nuns, in the guise of laymen, and in the guise of laywomen, we wish to be the servants of that holy being."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent! Sons of good family, all of you who long for the true Dharma, do just that. I too shall protect those who long for the true Dharma; I always walk and abide close beside them. By every means act as charioteers, understand what I have done, and make it firm. Then all of you, teach this: 'The permanent abode is the abode of the Tathāgata.'"

Then Prasenajit, king of the land of Kośala, commanded his ministers and generals: "Go with the fourfold army. A rākṣasa in human form has killed two thousand people less one and made a garland of their fingers. Smeared with fresh blood, with great strength and prowess, he roams about and is staying about forty krośas from this city. It is reported that he is overjoyed, thinking, 'Today I shall kill even my own mother and so make up the full two thousand people.' If this vicious, evil, savage one is killed, then at last all the soldiers in our villages, towns, mountain hamlets, and valleys will come out of their homes. As it is, just as crows and small birds are terrified of a hawk, all our people, the wood-gatherers, the grass-cutters, the people of other lands, and the guests no longer travel about or even speak at the mere mention of his name. So quickly carry the proclamation."

Then Prasenajit, king of the land of Kośala, set out together with the fourfold army, and it was proclaimed: "All you resplendent ones who are to kill the vicious, savage rākṣasa Aṅgulimāla, take in hand swords, bows, single-pointed vajras, short spears, and shields, sharpen all your weapons and implements, and set out well! Whoever kills the vicious rākṣasa Aṅgulimāla or strikes him with a weapon, and those riding elephants who are wounded, whoever, though

wounded, does not turn back from the battle: if he wants an elephant, he will be given the finest elephant. If he wants a horse, he will be given a horse to ride. If he wants gold, he will be given gold, gold coins, and millions besides. If he wants silver, he will be given a million in silver. He will be given diamonds, jewels, conch, crystal, coral, and the seven precious substances, millions of them. To one who wants clothing he will be given many kinds of cloth: divine garments, silk, fine kotampa cotton, cotton of the land of Vaṅga, and cotton of the land of Mathurā, of Bharukaccha, of Baringdra, of the south, of Saṅkāśika, and of Kuru-Pañcāla. To one who wants fields, villages, buffaloes, or women, the best of all of them will be given."

Then all who belonged to the royal attendants were terrified at the mere name of Aṅgulimāla, and not one of them came forth. The queen's retinue and the attendants, being under the power of others like dogs, faced death for the sake of their livelihood; taking up each his own weapons, the elephant riders, the horsemen, and the foot soldiers, finely adorned, came to where the king was.

Then the queen cried out, "Alas! Do not go near that evil one! Even if all the people and the other provinces were lost, it would not matter; but what if even a little harm should come to Your Majesty?"

Then, when the diviners, the astrologers, the royal chaplains, the learned men, and the readers of omens were asked whether Aṅgulimāla would survive today or not, the diviners and astrologers said, "Today Aṅgulimāla will be reduced to ashes."

But the king did not trust their words, and he went with the troops of the fourfold army to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and, afraid and terrified, his face and forehead covered with dust, the king sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One, endowed with all the wisdom of omniscience, said this to Prasenajit, king of the land of Kośala: "Great king, why are your face and forehead so covered with dust?"

The king replied, "The matter is this, Blessed One: a rākṣasa called Aṅgulimāla has killed one thousand nine hundred people, strung together a garland of their fingers, and, wearing the garland, he stays there saying, 'Fight with me!' He has cut off every way by which people come to me. He stays alone at the foot of an aśoka tree, and even the crows and hawks that circle there are terrified at his mere name. That is what I have to report."

The Blessed One said this to Prasenajit, king of Kośala: "Great king, do you wish to make war?"

The king replied, "The word of the Blessed One is the authority."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, shall I go as well?"

The king replied, "The Blessed One's saying that he will go is like good fortune for many sentient beings. Now Aṅgulimāla is as good as dead."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, if Aṅgulimāla comes here, what will you do?"

At that, the troops of the fourfold army were terrified to the core. But the king, knowing the greatness of the Tathāgata, was glad at heart, and without fear the king replied, "If Aṅgulimāla comes here, I suppose I shall be left all alone."

Then the Blessed One said to Prasenajit, king of Kośala, "Great king, look at the splendor of this Aṅgulimāla."

Then Prasenajit, king of Kośala, gazed at Aṅgulimāla for a long time without blinking. When he saw Aṅgulimāla's red eyes and his imposing form, Prasenajit, king of Kośala, was utterly afraid and terrified, and his hair stood on end. Like a hungry ghost being subdued, his armor fell apart, all his weapons slipped from their sheaths and fell everywhere like arrows from a quiver, and like a cat he crept to the foot of the Tathāgata's lion throne, saying, "I go for refuge to the Tathāgata, who looks upon all impartially, as upon Rāhula."

Then all the troops of the fourfold army heard that sound, and the elephants, the horses, the bullocks, and the foot soldiers broke apart like a routed army. Some fainted, some fell down, and some came close to death.

Then the Blessed One said to Prasenajit, king of Kośala, "Great king, listen to this verse. No harm will come, so do not be afraid.

Whoever before was heedless
But later has become heedful
Illuminates this world
Like the moon come forth from the clouds."

Then, to bring relief to all the people, the Blessed One sent forth a ray of light called the Aspect of Fearlessness, and all the sentient beings touched by that light became happy. The queen's retinue of Prasenajit, king of Kośala, his son, and all the people of the town, thinking, "The Tathāgata has tamed Aṅgulimāla," all came there.

Then King Prasenajit said this to the Blessed One: "Oh! Since the Blessed One, the guide who tames persons, the teacher of gods and humans, has established even one of such evil character as this in the true Dharma, oh, the Blessed One brings benefit to the whole world!"

The Blessed One said, "Being a steadfast bodhisattva, a great being, he first showed himself as though he were heedless, and later he showed his own greatness. So he has become beautiful in the world, like the moon freed from the clouds, and having delivered many koṭis of sentient beings, he also shows the greatness of the Tathāgata. Great king, Aṅgulimāla is not an evil man. He is called a bodhisattva, a great being, who wields skillful means."

The great king asked, "If he did wrong with his teacher's wife and became a demon through his teacher's curse, why is that not evil?"

The Blessed One said, "Aṅgulimāla did not do wrong with his teacher's wife. It was the teacher's wife whose mind was changed on seeing his form. Everyone will imagine that he committed a grave evil, when it was a play carried out through his teacher's doing. Great king, the bodhisattva is therefore like this: a donkey cannot bear a blow that an elephant can bear. In the same way, great king, śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas cannot bear being struck by the secret tusk spoken with hidden intent by the Tathāgata, the supreme elephant among humans. So being struck by the secret that the Tathāgata has spoken with hidden intent is borne by the Tathāgata alone.

"Great king, to the south of this buddhafield, past as many buddhafields as there are grains of sand in sixty-two Ganges rivers, there is a world system called Adorned with All Jewels. In that world system the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Joy to All the World Who See Him, Exalted Great Diligence, is presently dwelling, living, and abiding. There, there are no śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas at all; apart from the one vehicle, there is not even the name of another vehicle. There is no aging, no sickness, and no suffering; there is no unhappiness either. It is endowed with every kind of supreme happiness. Those sentient beings have immeasurable lifespans, and all those sentient beings have immeasurable splendor and beauty. For those beings there is no comparison, no cause, and no making, and there is nothing to compare with the world system Adorned with All Jewels. Great king, join your palms and rejoice in that Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Joy to All the World Who See Him, Exalted Great Diligence. That Tathāgata is this very Aṅgulimāla. Such is the greatness of the Buddha; the

domain of the Buddha is inconceivable."

Then the gods, humans, and asuras, the śrāvakas and the bodhisattvas, and Prasenajit, king of Kośala, together with the troops of the fourfold army, reviled and scorned the diviners and astrologers, saying, "Hey, you liars! Do not stay in my presence!", and drove them out.

Then, by the power of the Tathāgata, the world system with its gods, humans, and asuras, the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, Prasenajit, king of Kośala, the people of the villages, towns, markets, and valleys, the mountain dwellers, and all the sentient beings living in the land of Śrāvastī came there, bowed their heads at the feet of Aṅgulimāla, and with one voice spoke these verses:

Homage to you, who have a boundless body!
Homage to you, who have a body of skillful means!

Aṅgulimāla, we touch our heads to your feet;
at your gentle feet we beg your forgiveness.
Tathāgata, you who bear the name Aṅgulimāla,
in the form of a brahmin you came for our sake.
Buddha, your complexion blazing with splendor, today you have come here.
Glorious one, possessed of majesty and might, we beg your forgiveness.
Boundless body, who speak openly in words,
you, the perfect Buddha, are protector and refuge
for the many who sink again and again.
You have become the friend of the friendless.
Two buddhas who have passed beyond the world shine in beauty;
here their practice of the Dharma is utterly wondrous and marvelous.
Like the wonder of a lotus springing up from fire
are two buddhas in the world, such supreme teachers.

Then the Blessed One said to Prasenajit, king of Kośala, "Look, great king! Northward from this buddhafield, past as many world systems as there are grains of sand in forty-two Ganges rivers, there is a world system called Ever Delighted, Lovely and Devoted. There the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha called Essence of Devoted Delight, King of Heaped Precious Jewels, presently dwells, lives, and sustains himself. In that place there are no śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas at all. Apart from the one vehicle, not even the name of another vehicle exists. There is no aging, no sickness, and no suffering. All are endowed with every happiness, and those beings have immeasurable lifespans and immeasurable majesty and complexion. In that

world there is nothing to compare it to, neither cause nor agent. In that place of constant delight and devotion, beyond compare, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, Essence of Devoted Delight, King of Heaped Precious Jewels, presently dwells, lives, and sustains himself. Great king, join your palms and rejoice in him! That tathāgata is no other than this very youthful Mañjuśrī.

"Whoever hears the names of these two, the youthful Mañjuśrī and Aṅgulimāla, or constantly pays homage to them, those beings will see the world called Joy in their very homes, and the doors to the four kinds of lower realms will be closed to them. Even non-Buddhists, those who have incurred a defeat, and those who have committed the deeds of immediate retribution, if, having heard the names of these two, they mock them, despise them, or deride them, or recite them at the prompting of others, or even do so for the sake of gain, honor, or verses, the doors to the four lower realms will be closed to them. Any son or daughter of good family who makes these two names their protection will be protected in every wilderness and at every time of danger. In future too, they will be protected from all dangers, and all dangers that have arisen will be pacified. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, and piśācas will not be able to harm them."

Again the Blessed One said to Prasenajit, king of Kośala, "The word of the buddhas is of great nature. Such is the greatness of the conduct of bodhisattvas. Rejoice in these two great-natured elephants, Aṅgulimāla and the youthful Mañjuśrī, and give rise to the conduct of a bodhisattva as well. And do not forget Aṅgulimāla's mother; look after her. I freed his old mother from Aṅgulimāla's hands. My saying, 'Aṅgulimāla, do not kill your mother! By killing her you will not go to the higher realms,' and my placing myself between them at that very instant when he came on, holding his sword, was the skillful means for bringing him into the Dharma."

Then Aṅgulimāla's mother, standing in the sky at the height of about seven palm trees, spoke this verse:

The magical emanations of the Tathāgata
are not understood by many sentient beings.
The Buddha, king of illusionists, has a great body;
the Tathāgata has a body of skillful means.

Having said this, she vanished from that very spot. Then Prasenajit, king of Kośala, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, was that an illusion?"

The Blessed One said, "Great king, this mother was an emanation. It is just as the emanated mother said: the illusory conduct of bodhisattvas is likewise."

Then Aṅgulimāla's teacher, called Maṇibhadra, standing in the sky at the height of about seven palm trees, spoke these words: "Even if a jackal is friends with a lion for a long time, it cannot take up the sound of the lion's roar; the jackal flees at merely hearing it. And if a jackal gives the cry of a bear, is that the great lion king uttering his sound? The lion does not roar with the cry of a jackal or a bear; it proclaims the lion's sound. In the same way, though I, who am like a jackal, became the teacher of the bodhisattva, who is like a lion, and dwelt together with him for a long time, how could I ever take up the voice of the bodhisattva? If this were not skillful means, I would have died by his might; what need is there to speak of making him practice my foolish teachings, I who am like a hungry ghost, and making him listen to them? The bodhisattva does not practice foolish teachings. His conduct is the practice of loving-kindness toward all as toward an only child. The many illusory emanations of the Buddha are not understood by tens of millions of beings or by brahmin teachers; only the Buddha himself knows the illusions of the Buddha. The Tathāgata, the Buddha, is the king of illusionists."

The teacher's wife, Joy-Maker, said, "Alas! Though this being saw the waist of the brahmin's daughter, the milkmaid, he did not know it to be the greatness of the Buddha. Just as Cañcā was an illusion, so too I am an illusory emanation made by the Buddha. That is why I have related this to Prasenajit, king of Kośala."

"If an outcaste cannot approach you, O king, and if many beings would be overwhelmed by the glory and majesty of you who are the glory of beings, what need is there to speak of sitting in your presence? If, in this way, a human cannot instruct in the presence of a human, how could gods and humans ever instruct the Blessed One or change the Tathāgata's mind? The gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, piśācas, countless asuras, and garuḍas who serve the Tathāgata would bring harm upon such a one. If the thought should arise that the Blessed One too displays many kinds of evil deeds, know that, for the sake of beings in the future who will come to commit such terrible evils, the Tathāgata displays the body of skillful means that is the great illusion of the Buddha." Having said this, she vanished.

Then the king, once again utterly amazed, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, was that an illusion?"

The Blessed One said, "Great king, it is just as the three illusions, the teacher, the teacher's wife, and his mother, have said. Because my illusion is inconceivable, I emanated in those three forms. Aṅgulimāla came in this way in order to free many tens of millions of beings."

The king said, "Blessed One, if I give a great gift for seven years, may the Tathāgata Aṅgulimāla become the object of offering for the southern quarter."

The Blessed One said, "Great king, so may it be."

Then the world with its gods, humans, and asuras spoke these verses with one voice:

Homage to you, king of illusionists!
Tathāgata, great hero, body of skillful means,
perfectly endowed with the characteristics of skillful means,
you fully teach the supreme means, the sublime teachings.
You also establish beings in the spheres of skillful means;
through skillful means you display emanations everywhere.
The body of the Tathāgata is boundless,
boundless is his understanding, and boundless his renown.
The majesty of the Tathāgata is boundless.
Boundless Sugata, who display great power,
you reveal secret intentions beyond all bounds, without limit.
Boundless illuminator of the world!
The light rays of the Tathāgata are boundless,
his qualities endless, far beyond all counting.
The Tathāgata is matchless and immeasurable;
he reveals wisdom free of attachment, like space.
The body of the Tathāgata is like space.
The youthful Mañjuśrī brings benefit and brings peace.
As for the Sugata's coming for Aṅgulimāla's sake,
though one knows he came and did not come, it cannot be expressed.
The Sugata gazes evenly, as on the moon seized by Rāhu.

When they had spoken thus, the Blessed One was pleased. The world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, those śrāvakas, those bodhisattvas, and Prasenajit, king of Kośala, all of them rejoiced in the bodhisattva conduct of Aṅgulimāla and in birth in his buddhafield, and in the bodhisattva conduct of the youthful Mañjuśrī and in birth in his buddhafield, and they generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Rejoicing, they

praised what the Blessed One had spoken.

This concludes the noble Great Vehicle sūtra called Benefiting Aṅgulimāla, as hard to find as the udumbara flower, from the extensive scriptures of the Great Vehicle sūtras.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Śākyaprabha, the chief editor-translator the venerable Dharmatāśīla, the Chinese translator the venerable Tong Ācārya, and others.

Translator's Notes

• The youth's personal name, rendered here as "Lovely to All the World," and his birthplace "Mountain Ridge" are translated from the Tibetan, since their Sanskrit forms could not be identified with confidence. "The Veda of guarding the realm" renders an uncertain phrase, possibly statecraft or protective lore. "Like arrows and axes" is a tentative reading of an obscure phrase. The count "two thousand people less one" follows this Tibetan as it stands; other versions of the story give different numbers.
• "In the dusk of evening" takes the unusual phrase as an honorific expression for the dark of evening; the time reference is somewhat uncertain. "Sun-crest of radiant vigor" and "at this fitting time I bow to you and praise you" render compressed verse lines whose exact sense is not certain.
• "Limit of reality" renders yang dag pa'i mtha' (Skt. bhūtakoṭi), the ultimate point or reality-limit, and "limit" is used throughout these verses for the same word mtha' rather than "extreme," since here it denotes the culmination or final reality, not one of two wrong views. The Buddha's "Stop" plays on Aṅgulimāla's repeated command: he himself has stopped, abiding in the unconditioned, and urges Aṅgulimāla to stop his violence. The "sharp weapon" offered as toll is presumably the weapon of wisdom.
• As in the preceding verses, mtha' is rendered "limit" (Skt. koṭi), the ultimate point or culmination, not "extreme" in the sense of a wrong view.
• "Where there is no foundation" renders kun gzhi med pa, here most likely "without basis or ground" rather than a reference to the ālaya consciousness. "Where there is nothing base" renders tha ba med pa, whose sense in this line is uncertain. "Utter cessation" renders nye bar chad pa; in this list of epithets of nirvāṇa it denotes the complete cutting off of suffering, not the nihilist view.
• The refrain of the preceding piece continues: each stanza names a further "limit" (mtha', here the ultimate point or culmination, not an "extreme" in the sense of a wrong view) at which the Buddha abides. "The sublime" renders gya nom, "excellent, exquisite." "Abode and dwelling" renders gnas dang khang pa literally; the point is presumably that the Buddha's true dwelling is the ultimate, which Aṅgulimāla does not grasp.
• As in the preceding pieces, "limit" renders mtha', the ultimate point at which the Buddha abides, not an "extreme" in the sense of a wrong view. "Self and no self" renders nga dang nga med literally ("I and no-I"). "Support, protector, refuge, ally, island" echo the standard epithets of the Buddha as the world's support and refuge.
• As before, "limit" renders mtha', the ultimate point at which the Buddha abides, not an "extreme." In "the limit of purity where all afflictions are abandoned," byang mthar is read as "the pure (purified) limit"; it could also abbreviate byang chub, "the limit of awakening." In the refrain on nirvāṇa, bde mchog is "supreme bliss," not the deity Cakrasaṃvara. "Cutting off the

road" (lam gcod pa) plays on Aṅgulimāla's own highway banditry. The verses "All are terrified of punishment..." closely parallel Dhammapada 129–130; chad pa there means "punishment" (daṇḍa), not annihilationism. In "Cast the garland of fingers from your head," sor mo'i phreng ba could equally be read as the vocative "Aṅgulimāla, cast it from your head"; the literal garland seems intended. Gtso mo, "chief lady," is rendered "mother," as the context requires.

• Mi zad pa, used here of the Avīci hell, the weapon, the snake and Aṅgulimāla's deeds, is read throughout as mi bzad pa, "terrible, unbearable," which the contexts require; in "endless existence" (srid pa mi zad pa) it is kept as "endless." Dbye gnas, "dwelling in solitude," is read as dben gnas; the written form makes little sense. "Bandhujīvaka" renders rtsa lag 'tsho, literally "kin-sustaining," the standard rendering of the name of this red flower; "śiśumāra" likewise renders chu srin byis pa gsod, "the crocodile that kills children." Bla ma in "the feet of your elder" refers to the mother. Tshad shing, "rods," is a measuring staff; the exact length is uncertain. The finger garland is said here to come from 1,999 people, and Aṅgulimāla says he has killed 1,900.

• The verse line rendered "Buddha, rich in excellence and beautiful" (sangs rgyas nor la bzang po mdzes) is obscure; it may contain an epithet not identified here. "The twelve qualities of purification" (sbyangs pa'i yon tan bcu gnyis) are the dhūtaguṇa, the ascetic practices. "Spittle and ashes" renders mchil ma'i thal ba, perhaps "the ash of a spittoon"; the sense is something worthless thrown away. "Those outrageous ones" renders ya mtshan can, literally "the remarkable ones," evidently ironic. The speech continues into the next piece.

• □□□□□□□□□□□ here is the Buddha's son Rāhula, distinct from Rāhu (□□□□□□□) earlier. In the "restraint" example, □□□□□□ is taken in its everyday sense of restraining or stopping, not the doctrinal "cessation". □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is tentatively identified as Śroṇa Koṭiviṃśa, the wealthy disciple who renounced great riches (Tibetan gro bzhin skyes = Śroṇa, with □□□ "million" apparently reflecting koṭi); □□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is rendered literally as "Endless". In the verses, □□ addressing the Buddha is rendered as the honorific "Lord".

• "Two thousand people less one" follows this text's number (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), not the more familiar figure. In the Guardians' verses, the second line (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is read with □□□ in the sense of a debate challenge (rgol); and "my begging bowl" keeps the singular □□□□□□ although the four speak together. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

render □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (manuja) and □□□□□□ (mānava), standard terms in lists of things taken as a self; □□□□□□ in the later lists is rendered "one of Manu's line" as a variant of the same item. As the Tibetan stands, Aṅgulimāla recites the verse to Pūrṇa and asks its meaning, and Pūrṇa then explains it.

• "Having attained the ten grounds" follows the evident reading □□□□□ for the written □□□□□□□ ("ten times"), which makes no sense here. The "four kinds of sweetness" refers to the sweet essence of the earth eaten by beings at the beginning of the eon. The sentence "how could they trust a mere blind man?" is terse; it seems to mean that śrāvakas rely on one who truly sees, the Buddha, not on anyone at all. "A chickpea" for □□□□□ is a probable identification.

• "Born in the marshlands" renders □□□□□□□□ literally; it seems to denote a backward or uncultured birthplace. "Dull-witted" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, whose exact sense is uncertain. "The three views" is not further specified in the passage.

• "Acting in conformity with the world" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (lokānuvartana): the Buddha's appearing in an ordinary human body is an accommodation to worldly ways, so those who take that body as his real, flesh-and-blood nature reject this teaching. In the list of the low-born, □□□□□□□□ is rendered literally as "the lustful"; it may stand for a specific class of outcaste or person whose Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain. The □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ has been taken as "lacking in limbs" rather than "lacking all limbs".

• "Buddha element" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (buddhadhātu), here equivalent to the tathāgatagarbha. The simile of water and oil (literally "grain oil") is read as illustrating that the element and the afflictions never truly blend, though they lie together; the clause □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "cannot be perceived as one", i.e. never observed to mix. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered loosely as "careful and conscientious"; □□□□□□ is uncertain here. "Lords of Brahmā" literally renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, i.e. the Brahmā rulers of the Brahmā heavens.

• □□□□□□□□, praised here as supreme among Vinaya holders, is identified as Upāli, the Buddha's foremost disciple in the Vinaya. □□□□□□□□ is identified as Sundarananda (Nanda), foremost in handsomeness. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the youthful god Skanda (Kumāra); the identification is likely but not certain. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "the corrupt and outrageous", refers to immoral monks. The sentence about images of Brahmā and other gods is read as saying that the relics and stūpas left as a means render such divine images no longer objects of refuge.

• The passage opens in the middle of Mañjuśrī's verse; the closing quotation mark ends it. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as speech with a hidden or indirect meaning, which bewilders the hearers. □□□□□□ in the illusion simile is rendered "being caught in a snare"; the sense is uncertain. In "the tigers among bodhisattvas ... not to be feared", □□□□□□□□□□□□□ could also mean "fearless"; the rendering follows the context of Mañjuśrī's rebuke.

• The figure of one thousand nine hundred and ninety-nine (literally "two thousand less one") emanations is as the Tibetan gives it. "The fourth fascicle" marks a division (bam po) of the Tibetan text. In "through the qualities gained from what he himself has undergone", the sense is that the child's own past merit transforms the parents' vigor and splendor; the phrasing is terse. Both □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Śāradvatīputra) and □□□□□□□□□ are rendered Śāriputra.

• The term rendered "icchantika" is Tibetan 'dod chen pa (once 'dod mangs), "one of great desire," the standard rendering of Sanskrit icchantika in this sūtra; the passage is the sūtra's characteristic paradox comparing the icchantika's inverted "perfections" with those of the śrāvakas. In Aṅgulimāla's opening question the name Mahāmaudgalyāyana carries an instrumental particle, which would yield "if the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana had not found the Tathāgata"; it is taken here as a vocative, which fits Mahāmaudgalyāyana's reply. The sentence about not all people seeing the magical display is terse; it is read as a rhetorical question ("is it not the Blessed One alone who knows it?"). The speakers of the successive "he

said" exchanges about the sick alternate between Mahāmaudgalyāyana and Aṅgulimāla and are not named in the Tibetan, so they are left unnamed. "Making the body heavy and light" likely reflects the Āyurvedic paired therapies of nourishing and reducing (bṛṃhaṇa and laṅghana).

• "Asafoetida" renders shing kun (Skt. hiṅgu), the pungent medicinal resin; the simile contrasts genuine and counterfeit medicine. "Senseless" renders phyugs med, which is obscure as written; it is taken in the sense of a foolish, deluded person. "Moral discipline of a youth" (gzhon nu'i tshul khrims) and "youth" in Aṅgulimāla's reply are rendered literally; the term apparently refers to the precepts of a junior or novice monastic, and Aṅgulimāla plays on its sense. In the list of conventional acts, "I attend to what my nine openings require" renders rma dgu nas de'i bgyi ba bgyi, the body's nine orifices; "I do not know the gods" (lha ma 'tshal) is literal and uncertain. "The moral discipline concerning false speech" renders brdzun smra ba'i tshul khrims literally, in a context where Aṅgulimāla says he does not keep the precept of abandoning false speech. "Deaf" renders 'on pa throughout the closing simile.

• "Intentional speech" renders ldem ngag (Skt. saṃdhābhāṣā), veiled or allusive teaching. "What is one? What is...?" renders ci gcig ci, the opening of the catechism of a young novice (the "questions for a boy," which begin "What is one? All beings subsist on food"); Aṅgulimāla reinterprets each item from the Great Vehicle standpoint. The line rendered "As if bestowing it on people" reads mi sbyin, which is obscure here and may conceal the name of a class of celestial singer; it is taken literally. "Amalaka" renders skyu ru ra (Skt. āmalaka), the emblic myrobalan fruit, a stock image for something seen plainly.

• "By way of the entry" renders 'ong ba'i sgo nas, a play on the sense of āyatana (sense source) as a "door of coming in." "Immutability" renders g.yung drung. The phrase rendered "across forty leagues ... leaving not even a fathom's gap" (gnag pa'i dgongs bzhi bcur 'dom gang med pa'i bar du) is obscure; gnag pa'i dgongs is taken as a unit of distance (perhaps a "cow's call," Skt. gavyūti or krośa), and the sense may rather be that the procession filled the whole way without a gap. "The great lion and tiger, having waged a great battle" renders seng ge stag chen po dang thab mo chen po bkye, also somewhat uncertain. Kācalindika is a proverbially soft cloth.

• "The thirty-two marks" renders brgyad bzhi mtshan, literally "eight-four marks," that is, eight times four. "The seven raised places" (bdun mtho) is the major mark of having seven fleshy, well-rounded parts of the body. The names of the northern world system (Dga' ba bskyed du med pa) and of its buddha (Blo gros bskyed du med pa'i yon tan 'byung gnas sa'i dbang phyug rgyal po) could not be identified with confidence in Sanskrit and are translated by meaning. "Limit of reality" renders yang dag pa'i mtha' (Skt. bhūtakoṭi); "limit of the unborn" renders ma skyes pa'i mtha' and mi skye ba'i mtha'.

• The text abbreviates its repeated episodes: the formula "is likewise to be abbreviated as above" is the Tibetan's own instruction that each visit and dialogue follows the pattern of the Vairocana episode. In that episode the phrase "having come here as before" is compressed in the Tibetan; the reply that follows, spoken in the first person, is evidently given by the Tathāgata they visited, in keeping with the pattern of the preceding episode. Several buddha and world-system names (Glory of Complete Victory, Supreme Profundity, Source of the Life of Fragrance, Spread Parasol, and the world names) could not be identified with Sanskrit forms with confidence and are translated by meaning. "Feet of the power of miraculous ability" renders the bases of miraculous power (ṛddhipāda).

• Most of the buddha and world-system names in this list could not be matched to Sanskrit forms with confidence and are translated by meaning; Candragarbha, Sāgaradatta and Vajragarbha are given in Sanskrit as standard equivalents of their Tibetan forms. "Excellent Flavor" renders bro, which can also mean fragrance or savor.

• The buddha name ke’i la sa'i snying po is a Tibetan transcription; it most likely represents

Kailāsa, though kesara, the filaments of a flower, would suit the world name Endowed with Flowers, so "Essence of Kailāsa" is tentative. Most other names are translated by meaning because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence; Gaṅgādatta follows the regular pattern "Given by the Ganges", and the world name Samantabhadra is the standard Sanskrit for kun tu bzang po. The piece ends mid-sentence; the next piece continues it.

• From the northeast onward the Tibetan itself shortens the formula, naming only the world and the Tathāgata to be asked and stating that the rest is abbreviated as before. Most names are translated by meaning, as their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence; Ratnaketu is the standard Sanskrit for rin po che'i tog. "Gold of the Jambū River" is jāmbūnada, the finest gold in Indian tradition.

• Ratnasambhava, Siddhārtha and Amitābha are given in Sanskrit as the standard equivalents of their Tibetan forms; most other names are translated by meaning. "Nāga among Men" renders skyes bu klu (puruṣanāga), an epithet for an eminent person. "Endowed with Gifts" takes byin pa as "given, gift"; it could also be read as "blessing".

• The names of these world systems and buddhas are rendered by meaning, since most cannot be securely matched to Sanskrit forms. Night lily renders kumuda, the white water lily that opens at night. "Saki" (□□□□) in the eighth upward world system and its buddha is unidentified, perhaps a transcription of a plant or perfume name, and is kept as written; likewise the world system □□□□□□□□□□ is a transcription of an Indic name that I cannot identify with confidence, so it is given as spelled. The piece ends mid-sentence; the next piece supplies the world system for the second downward buddha.

• Most names of world systems and buddhas here are rendered by meaning, since they cannot be securely matched to Sanskrit forms; Sahakāra is a kind of fragrant mango tree. In Śākyamuni's instruction the phrase □□□□□ ("about me") is somewhat elliptical and is taken as the subject of the question the two are to put. The final speech is attributed in the Tibetan to "the youthful Mañjuśrī" as speaker, though it reports what happened to both, hence "us".

• "Proclaims them for the sake of others" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the verb □□□ ordinarily means "to mock", which does not fit, so a reading such as "explain" or "propagate" is assumed. "The four destinies" are presumably the lower rebirths. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("flawed and disfigured") is obscure and rendered tentatively, as is □□□□□□□□□□ ("flawless", literally perhaps "without crack or blemish"). Dust (□□□□) here carries its usual sense of the defilement of passion. The Peerless Dhāraṇī sūtra is translated by meaning; its identification is uncertain.

• "From being without proper order to a Dharma body of proper order" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose exact sense is uncertain. The sentence about beings "with bodies lacking limbs" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

• The clause about the supreme physician is syntactically difficult; it is read here as the Buddha cultivating virtue in accordance with what the supreme physician (the Buddha himself, in former teaching) taught about the Dharma body. "A body born in keeping with the cause that was heard" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the sense appears to be a body that corresponds to its cause, the teaching heard and given. "The Dharma of mortality" renders □□□□□□□□□□□ literally and may mean teaching them about death and impermanence. "Strive earnestly toward suchness" could also be read adverbially as "strive earnestly in exactly that way". The āmalaka (emblic myrobalan) fruit is a stock image for something seen in full and clearly.
• □□□□□ and □□□□□□, in a list of crops and settlements, could not be identified with confidence and are given as transliterations. In this piece □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ are not proper names but ordinary phrases ("those endowed with moral discipline", "all the buddhas"), and are translated as such.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "washerman" (one who cleans cloth); the occupation is not certain. □□□□ in the list of foods is tentatively rendered "buttermilk". In □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

and the ending of the "unmoving ground" episode (□□□

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.